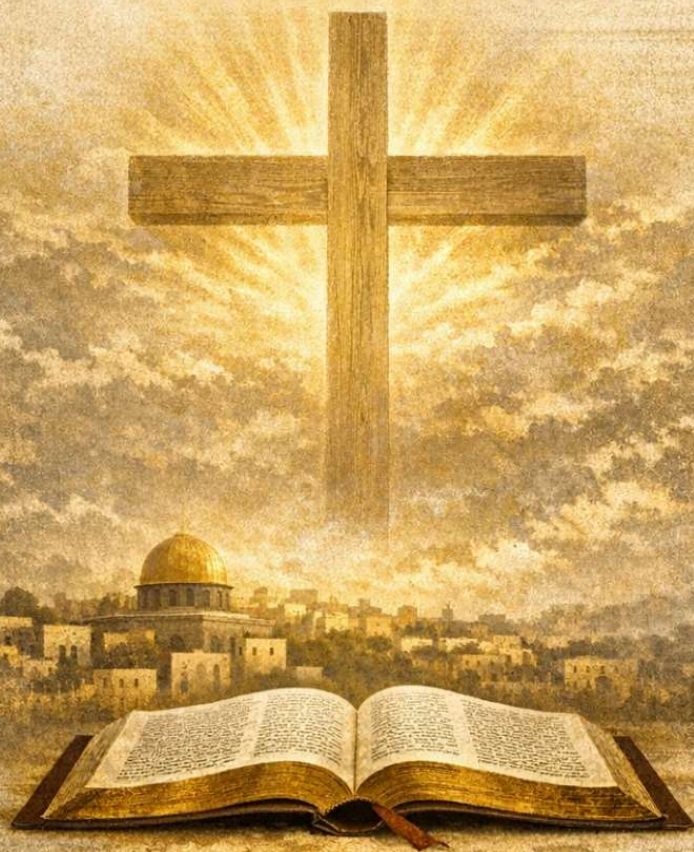


ONE GOD — IN — JESUS CHRIST

Pillars of Apostolic Doctrine:

A Manual for Teaching, Preaching, and Discipleship



One God in Jesus Christ

One God in Jesus Christ

Pillars of Apostolic Doctrine: A Manual for
Teaching, Preaching, and Discipleship

Author: Alfredo B. Santiago

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First Edition

One God in Jesus Christ

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Dedication

To the called of God in Jesus Christ.

Epigraph

“In him dwelleth all the fulness of the Godhead bodily.” — Colossians 2:9

Preface

The foundation of the Apostolic church is the revelation that **the one true God has made Himself known in the person of Jesus Christ**. This revelation is not an optional doctrine, nor a theological nuance. It is the center of the Christian faith, the anchor of the church, and the lens through which all Scripture is understood. Every dimension of Apostolic life — doctrine, worship, holiness, discipleship, leadership, and mission — flows from the identity of Jesus.

To understand what God has conveyed, it is essential that we first know **who** He is. And we can only know Him through what He has revealed of Himself in **Jesus Christ**. God is not known through speculation, imagination, or human philosophy. He is known only by revelation — and that revelation is centered, embodied, and made visible in Christ. Everything God has made known — His nature, His will, His salvation, His holiness, and His purpose — is revealed in Him.

This manual is written to preserve and proclaim that revelation with clarity and conviction. In an age marked by doctrinal confusion, spiritual instability, and the rise of experience without foundation, the church must return to Scripture as its final authority. The Apostolic message is not shaped by culture, tradition, or sentiment. It is shaped by the Word of God and the pattern established by the apostles.

The chapters that follow are designed to provide a doctrinal foundation for believers, a teaching curriculum for the church, and a leadership guide for ministers and workers. The structure is intentional: beginning with the authority of Scripture, moving through the core doctrines of the faith, and culminating in the ministry responsibilities of those who teach and lead. The goal is not merely to inform but to establish; not merely to explain but to equip; not merely to teach but to form a people grounded in truth.

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The tone of this manual is deliberate. It avoids speculation, emotionalism, and philosophical abstraction. It speaks plainly where Scripture speaks plainly. It calls the church to fidelity, to holiness, and to the disciplined transmission of doctrine. It is written to be taught, studied, preached, and lived.

The burden behind this work is simple and weighty: **that the revelation of Jesus Christ — who He is, what He has done, and what He requires — remains clear, uncorrupted, and faithfully proclaimed in every generation.**

May this manual strengthen the hands of those who teach, steady the hearts of those who lead, and ground the lives of those who believe. May it serve the church as a stable doctrinal foundation in a shifting world. And above all, may it exalt the name of Jesus Christ, the one true God revealed to us, known to us, and present with us.

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How to Use This Book

This book is written as a doctrinal manual and teaching curriculum. You can use it for personal study, one-on-one discipleship, small groups, leadership training, or church-wide instruction.

Who This Book Is For

How Each Chapter Is Structured

Each chapter begins with a core teaching outline and develops the doctrine from Scripture. For teaching use, each chapter should conclude with: (1) a summary, (2) study questions, and (3) ministry/application notes.

Suggested Pacing

- **Personal study:** 1 chapter per week, with notes and Scripture cross-references.
- **Class setting:** 1 chapter over 1–2 sessions (teaching + discussion).
- **Leadership training:** Assign reading, then use the study questions as oral review.

Intent of the Book

One God in Jesus Christ Pillars of Apostolic Doctrine: A Manual for Teaching, Preaching, and Discipleship

Purpose

This book is written to establish a clear, authoritative, and transferable foundation for Apostolic doctrine. Its purpose is to articulate what the church must believe, how the church must teach it, and how leaders must guard and transmit it. Every chapter is designed to anchor the reader in the revelation of the One God in Jesus Christ and to provide a doctrinal framework that shapes the life, worship, mission, and identity of the church.

Doctrinal Center

The central truth of this manual is the biblical revelation that **there is One God, fully and perfectly revealed in the person of Jesus Christ**. This truth is not one doctrine among many; it is the foundation upon which all Apostolic teaching, preaching, discipleship, and ministry practice stands. Every section of this book flows from and returns to this revelation.

Scope

This manual addresses three essential dimensions of Apostolic life:

1. Doctrinal Foundation

The book defines the core doctrines of the Apostolic church with clarity and precision. It establishes the theological backbone necessary for sound preaching, teaching, and Christian living. The aim is not to explore possibilities but to declare truth.

2. Teaching Curriculum

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The structure of the book is intentionally designed for instruction. Its chapters and modules provide a complete teaching pathway for new believers, discipleship classes, leadership development, and church-wide formation. The content is organized for clarity, reproducibility, and doctrinal fidelity.

3. Leadership Formation and Guarding the Flock

Doctrine shapes ministry. This manual equips leaders to handle Scripture responsibly, teach with authority, guard against false doctrine, and maintain the Apostolic identity of the church. It provides the principles and practices necessary for doctrinal integrity across generations.

Posture

The tone of this manual is deliberate:

- **Biblical, not philosophical**
- **Apostolic, not ecumenical**
- **Authoritative, not speculative**
- **Precise, not emotional**
- **Pastoral, not sentimental**

Its aim is clarity, conviction, and fidelity to Scripture.

Intended Use

This book is designed to function as:

- a doctrinal reference for the church
- a teaching manual for discipleship and instruction
- a leadership guide for ministers and workers

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- a guardrail against doctrinal drift
- a foundation for preaching and teaching
- a long-term resource for the formation of believers and leaders

It is written to serve the church for years to come, providing a stable and enduring doctrinal standard.

Burden

The burden of this manual is simple and weighty: **to ensure that the revelation of Jesus Christ—who He is, what He has done, and what He requires—remains clear, uncorrupted, and faithfully proclaimed in every generation.**

SECTION I

FOUNDATIONS OF APOSTOLIC DOCTRINE

This section establishes the essential groundwork upon which all Apostolic teaching stands. It defines the authority of Scripture, the pattern given by Christ and practiced by the apostles, and the indispensable role of doctrine in salvation. These chapters form the structural base of the entire manual, ensuring that every subsequent doctrine is rooted in the Word, aligned with the apostolic pattern, and anchored in truth. Before the church can teach, preach, or disciple, it must first understand the foundation on which it stands.

Chapter 1 — The Authority of Scripture

Apostolic Doctrine Begins With the Word of God

Chapter 1 — The Authority of Scripture

Apostolic Doctrine Begins With the Word of God

I. Introduction: Why Everything Begins With Scripture

Apostolic doctrine stands or falls on the authority of Scripture. If the Word is not inspired, doctrine becomes opinion. If the Word is not final, doctrine becomes negotiable. If the Word is not sufficient, doctrine becomes incomplete.

Scripture declares itself to be truth (John 17:17), forever settled (Psalm 119:89), and profitable for doctrine (2 Timothy 3:16–17). The apostolic church begins with the Word because God has spoken, and His Word is binding.

II. What Scripture Is

1. Scripture as God-Breathed Revelation

Scripture is not the record of human religious thought; it is the revelation of God Himself. All Scripture is given by inspiration of God (2 Timothy 3:16–17). Holy men spoke as they were moved by the Holy Ghost (2 Peter 1:20–21). God, who spoke through the prophets, has now spoken through His Son (Hebrews 1:1–2). Because its source is divine, its authority is absolute.

2. Scripture as Inerrant and Trustworthy

God cannot lie (Titus 1:2). Therefore, His Word cannot err. Every word of God is pure (Proverbs 30:5). The words of the Lord are flawless (Psalm 12:6). Heaven and earth may pass, but His words will not pass

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away (Matthew 24:35). Inerrancy is the foundation of doctrinal certainty.

3. Scripture as Sufficient

Scripture contains everything necessary for salvation and doctrine. It makes one wise unto salvation (2 Timothy 3:15). God commands that nothing be added or taken away (Deuteronomy 4:2; Revelation 22:18–19). The Word is complete. The church’s task is not to improve it, but to obey it.

III. How Scripture Speaks

1. Progressive Revelation

God reveals truth across time—line upon line, precept upon precept (Isaiah 28:10). The law was a shadow (Hebrews 10:1), a schoolmaster leading to Christ (Galatians 3:24). Jesus expounded in all the Scriptures the things concerning Himself (Luke 24:27). Revelation progresses, but never contradicts.

2. The Unity of the Biblical Narrative

Though written over centuries, Scripture speaks with one voice. The Scriptures testify of Christ (John 5:39). All the prophets give witness to Him (Acts 10:43). The unity of Scripture is evidence of its divine origin. The Bible is one revelation, not a collection of disconnected writings.

3. The Authority of the Written Word Over All Other Voices

Man lives by every word that proceeds from the mouth of God (Matthew 4:4). If a message does not align with Scripture, there is no light in it (Isaiah 8:20). The Bereans searched the Scriptures daily (Acts 17:11). Tradition must never make the Word ineffective (Mark 7:13). God magnifies His Word above His name (Psalm 138:2).

IV. How Doctrine Emerges From Scripture

1. Exegesis, Not Eisegesis

Doctrine is discovered, not invented. The Levites read the book and gave the sense (Nehemiah 8:8). We must rightly divide the Word of truth (2 Timothy 2:15). Paul reasoned from the Scriptures (Acts 17:2–3). Exegesis draws truth out; eisegesis forces ideas in.

2. The Role of Context

Philip asked the Ethiopian, “Understandest thou what thou readest?” (Acts 8:30). Understanding required context—historical, linguistic, and theological. Error comes from not knowing the Scriptures (Matthew 22:29). The Word must dwell richly (Colossians 3:16). The sum of God’s Word is truth (Psalm 119:160).

3. The Danger of Proof-Texting

The unlearned twist the Scriptures to their own destruction (2 Peter 3:16). Satan quoted Scripture out of context (Matthew 4:5–7). Paul declared the whole counsel of God (Acts 20:27). Proof-texting produces error; the whole Word produces doctrine.

V. The Church’s Responsibility to Scripture

1. Submission to the Word

Believers must be doers of the Word (James 1:22). Jesus said that continuing in His Word leads to truth (John 8:31–32). A pure life is shaped by the Word (Psalm 119:9). Those who hear and obey build on the rock (Luke 6:46–49). Obedience is greater than sacrifice (1 Samuel 15:22).

2. Teaching the Whole Counsel of God

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Paul withheld nothing (Acts 20:27). Timothy was commanded to preach the Word (2 Timothy 4:2–4). The Great Commission includes teaching all things Christ commanded (Matthew 28:19–20). Pastors must feed with knowledge and understanding (Jeremiah 3:15). Apostolic teaching is comprehensive, not selective.

3. Guarding Against Additions and Subtractions

God warns against adding or diminishing (Deuteronomy 12:32; Revelation 22:18–19). Any other gospel is accursed (Galatians 1:8–9). We must contend for the faith once delivered (Jude 3). Those who teach otherwise must be rejected (1 Timothy 6:3–5). The purity of doctrine depends on the purity of Scripture.

Because Scripture is authoritative, inspired, and final, the church does not invent its own structure or practices. The apostolic pattern is not a cultural preference — it is the revealed order of God. The same Word that establishes doctrine also establishes the pattern by which the church must live.

VI. Conclusion: The Word as the Foundation of All Doctrine

Every doctrine in this book stands on the authority of Scripture. If Scripture is not final, doctrine becomes flexible. If Scripture is not sufficient, doctrine becomes unstable. If Scripture is not authoritative, doctrine becomes optional.

But Scripture is final. Scripture is sufficient. Scripture is authoritative. Therefore apostolic doctrine stands firm.

VII. Summary

1. Scripture is God-breathed revelation and therefore carries absolute authority.

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2. Because God cannot lie, His Word is trustworthy and establishes doctrinal certainty.
 3. Scripture is sufficient for salvation, doctrine, and the church's mission.
 4. Doctrine must be drawn from the text (exegesis), not forced into it (eisegesis).
 5. Context and the whole counsel of God protect the church from proof-texting and error.
 6. The church is responsible to submit to Scripture, teach it fully, and guard against additions and subtractions.
-

VIII. Study Questions

1. Why does Apostolic doctrine “stand or fall” on the authority of Scripture?
 2. How do 2 Timothy 3:16–17 and 2 Peter 1:20–21 define the source of Scripture?
 3. What is the difference between exegesis and eisegesis, and why does it matter?
 4. Give an example of how ignoring context can lead to doctrinal error.
 5. Why is proof-texting dangerous—even when the verse quoted is true?
 6. What practical habits can a local church adopt to “teach the whole counsel of God”?
-

IX. Ministry / Application

1. **For teachers:** Build lessons around a primary text, then confirm with supporting passages—avoid isolated verses.

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2. For preachers: Aim to preach “text-first” sermons where the main point is the text’s main point.

3. For discipleship: Assign one passage per week for memorization and one for contextual study (read the whole chapter).

4. For leaders: Set a standard for doctrinal unity by requiring ministry workers to be grounded in foundational passages.

X. Memory Verse

1. 2 Timothy 3:16 — “All scripture is given by inspiration of God, and is profitable for doctrine, for reproof, for correction, for instruction in righteousness:”

Chapter 2 — The Apostolic Pattern

The Model Given by Christ, Practiced by the Apostles, and Preserved by the Church

Chapter 2 — The Apostolic Pattern

The Model Given by Christ, Practiced by the Apostles, and Preserved by the Church

I. Introduction: Why Pattern Matters

The apostolic church is not defined by preference, culture, or tradition. It is defined by **pattern**—the divinely revealed model of doctrine, practice, and spiritual life established by Christ and continued by His apostles.

Paul wrote, “*Hold fast the form of sound words*” (2 Timothy 1:13). The word *form* means **pattern, blueprint, structure**.

The apostolic pattern is the standard by which the church measures doctrine, worship, leadership, holiness, mission, and identity. To be apostolic is to follow the pattern.

II. What “Apostolic” Means

1. Apostolic = Sent by God

The word *apostle* means “one who is sent.” Jesus is the first and chief Apostle (Hebrews 3:1). He sent His disciples with His authority (John 20:21). The apostolic church is a **sent** church—commissioned, empowered, and governed by Christ.

2. Apostolic = Built on the Foundation of the Apostles

The church is “*built upon the foundation of the apostles and prophets, Jesus Christ Himself being the chief cornerstone*” (Ephesians 2:20). Christ is the cornerstone; the apostles laid the doctrinal foundation;

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the church builds on that foundation, not beside it. No new foundation can be laid (1 Corinthians 3:11).

3. Apostolic = Continuing in Their Doctrine

Acts 2:42 defines the early church: “**They continued steadfastly in the apostles’ doctrine.**” Not opinions, innovations, or cultural trends, but doctrine—the teaching delivered by Christ and proclaimed by His apostles.

To be apostolic is to believe what they believed and teach what they taught.

III. The Pattern Revealed in the Book of Acts

Acts is not merely history; it is **pattern**. It shows how the church is meant to function.

Acts 2:42 provides the core structure:

- **Doctrine** – truth taught, received, and obeyed.
- **Fellowship** – unity, generosity, shared life.
- **Breaking of Bread** – communion, remembrance, covenant identity.
- **Prayers** – a praying church is an apostolic church.

Beyond this, Acts reveals additional elements of the apostolic pattern:

1. Apostolic Preaching

Peter’s message in Acts 2 sets the model: Christ-centered, Scripture-based, convicting, and calling for obedience. Apostolic preaching is proclamation, not performance.

2. Apostolic Conversion

Every conversion in Acts follows the same pattern: faith, repentance, water baptism in Jesus' name, and receiving the Holy Ghost. This is not coincidence—it is **pattern**.

3. Apostolic Power

Miracles, signs, and wonders accompany the apostolic church (Acts 2:43; Acts 5:12). Power is not for display but for witness (Acts 1:8).

4. Apostolic Community

Believers shared resources, supported one another, and lived with spiritual unity (Acts 2:44–47). Unity is doctrinal, not sentimental.

5. Apostolic Mission

The church moved outward: Jerusalem, Judea, Samaria, and the ends of the earth. The apostolic church is always expanding.

IV. Why Pattern Matters

1. God Works Through Patterns

God instructed Noah with a pattern (Genesis 6:14–16), Moses with a pattern for the tabernacle (Exodus 25:9), and David with a pattern for the temple (1 Chronicles 28:11–12). The apostles received a pattern for the church. God's work is never random.

2. Patterns Protect Doctrine

Without pattern, truth becomes flexible, worship becomes entertainment, holiness becomes optional, and leadership becomes political. Pattern preserves identity.

3. Patterns Preserve Continuity

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The apostolic church today must look like the apostolic church in Acts—not culturally, but doctrinally, spiritually, and missionally. The same gospel, the same name, the same Spirit, the same power, the same mission.

V. Dangers of Departing From the Pattern

1. Innovation Without Revelation

Israel's greatest errors came from "doing what was right in their own eyes" (Judges 21:25). Not every new idea is truth.

2. Emotionalism Replacing Doctrine

Emotion can inspire, but it cannot anchor. Jesus warned of those who receive the word with joy but have no root (Matthew 13:20–21).

3. Cultural Accommodation

When the church imitates the world, it loses its identity. Paul warned, "Be not conformed to this world" (Romans 12:2).

4. Doctrinal Drift

"We ought to give the more earnest heed... lest at any time we should let them slip" (Hebrews 2:1). Drift is subtle; pattern prevents drift.

VI. Conclusion: The Apostolic Pattern Is the Church's Blueprint

The apostolic pattern is not nostalgia—it is **command**. It is the model Christ gave, the apostles practiced, and the church must preserve.

To be apostolic is not to claim a label. It is to follow a pattern.

Doctrine. Worship. Holiness. Mission. Community. Power. Leadership. Identity.

All shaped by the pattern.

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Because the apostolic pattern shapes every dimension of the church's life, it also shapes the way salvation is proclaimed, understood, and obeyed. The same pattern that governs worship, mission, and community also governs the believer's response to the gospel. To understand how salvation works, we must understand doctrine, for doctrine reveals the pattern by which the new birth is experienced.

VII. Summary

1. The apostolic church is defined by a divinely revealed pattern, not by culture, preference, or tradition.
2. To be apostolic is to be sent by Christ, built on the apostles' foundation, and steadfast in their doctrine.
3. The Book of Acts functions as a church blueprint, showing doctrine, fellowship, breaking of bread, and prayers as core pillars.
4. Acts displays consistent apostolic preaching, conversion, power, community, and mission.
5. God repeatedly works through patterns, and those patterns protect doctrine and preserve continuity across generations.
6. Departing from the pattern leads to innovation without revelation, emotionalism without roots, cultural accommodation, and doctrinal drift.

VIII. Study Questions

1. What does it mean for the church to be defined by a "pattern" rather than by preference?
2. How does Acts 2:42 function as a blueprint for apostolic church life?

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3. Which elements of apostolic preaching and conversion appear repeatedly throughout the Book of Acts?
 4. Why do patterns protect doctrine and preserve continuity across generations?
 5. What are practical signs that a church is drifting from the apostolic pattern?
 6. How can leaders correct “innovation without revelation” while still addressing real ministry needs?
-

IX. Ministry / Application

- 1. For teachers:** Teach Acts as a pattern book—show repeated conversion accounts and have students identify the consistent elements.
 - 2. For preachers:** Preach “pattern sermons” from Acts 2, 8, 10, and 19 that call hearers to the same apostolic response.
 - 3. For discipleship:** Build a simple pathway for new believers anchored in Acts 2:42 (doctrine, fellowship, breaking of bread, prayers).
 - 4. For leaders:** Evaluate church practices by Scripture: keep what matches the apostolic pattern, correct what conflicts, and avoid novelty that dilutes doctrine.
-

X. Memory Verse

- 1. Acts 2:42** — “And they continued stedfastly in the apostles’ doctrine and fellowship, and in breaking of bread, and in prayers.”

Chapter 3 — Doctrine and Salvation

Truth Precedes Obedience; Revelation Precedes
Redemption

Chapter 3 — Doctrine and Salvation

Truth Precedes Obedience; Revelation Precedes Redemption

I. Introduction: Salvation Requires Doctrine

Salvation is not an undefined spiritual experience. It is a **biblically revealed process** grounded in truth. Scripture teaches that a person cannot call on Christ without believing, cannot believe without hearing, and cannot hear without a preacher (Romans 10:14). Doctrine is therefore not optional—it is the **framework** through which God reveals the way of salvation.

Experience may awaken a person, but **doctrine directs them**. Emotion may stir the heart, but **truth transforms the soul**. The apostolic church proclaims salvation as the apostles preached it, taught it, and practiced it.

II. What Doctrine Is

Doctrine is not opinion, tradition, or denominational preference. It is **teaching derived from Scripture**, shaping both belief and behavior.

1. Doctrine Defines the Faith

Doctrine establishes the boundaries of truth. Paul instructed Timothy to "take heed unto the doctrine" because doctrine preserves both the preacher and the hearer (1 Timothy 4:16).

2. Doctrine Reveals God's Plan

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Salvation is not discovered through personal intuition. It is revealed through the Word. Jesus opened the Scriptures to His disciples so they could understand the necessity of His death, burial, and resurrection (Luke 24:44–47).

3. Doctrine Produces Obedience

True doctrine leads to obedience. The believers in Rome "obeyed from the heart that form of doctrine" delivered to them (Romans 6:17). Doctrine is not merely information—it is **instruction that demands response**.

Having defined what doctrine is, we now turn to why doctrine is essential to salvation and why no one can be saved apart from the truth God has revealed. Doctrine is not an accessory to salvation — it is the framework that reveals how the gospel is obeyed and how the new birth is experienced.

III. Why Doctrine Is Essential to Salvation

1. Faith Must Be Anchored in Truth

Faith comes by hearing, and hearing by the Word of God (Romans 10:17). A person cannot believe correctly if they do not hear correctly. False teaching produces false confidence; true doctrine produces saving faith.

2. The Gospel Must Be Obeyed

Paul declared that the gospel is the death, burial, and resurrection of Jesus Christ (1 Corinthians 15:1–4). But he also taught that the gospel must be **obeyed** (2 Thessalonians 1:8). Doctrine reveals how the believer participates in the gospel through repentance, baptism, and Spirit infilling.

3. Salvation Is a Revealed Pattern

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The new birth is not a human invention. Jesus declared, "Except a man be born of water and of the Spirit, he cannot enter into the kingdom of God" (John 3:5). Doctrine explains this pattern and anchors it in Scripture.

IV. The Relationship Between Doctrine and Experience

1. Experience Confirms Truth, Not Replaces It

The apostles received the Holy Ghost with the evidence of speaking in tongues (Acts 2:1–4). This experience confirmed the promise Jesus gave (Acts 1:5). Experience follows doctrine; it does not define doctrine.

2. The Spirit and the Word Agree

The Holy Ghost guides believers into all truth (John 16:13), never contradicting Scripture. Any spiritual experience must align with the written Word.

3. Emotion Cannot Substitute for Revelation

Many receive the Word with joy but have no root (Matthew 13:20–21). Doctrine provides the root system that stabilizes faith.

V. The Consequences of Doctrinal Drift

1. Drift Produces Deception

Paul warned that some would depart from the faith, giving heed to seducing spirits and doctrines of devils (1 Timothy 4:1). Drift begins subtly—by neglecting doctrine.

2. Drift Produces Division

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When doctrine is abandoned, unity collapses. The early church was united because they continued steadfastly in the apostles' doctrine (Acts 2:42).

3. Drift Produces Powerlessness

A church without doctrine becomes a church without authority. The power of the apostolic church flows from its alignment with truth.

VI. Conclusion: Salvation Demands Doctrine

Doctrine is not an academic exercise. It is the **map** that leads the sinner to Christ, the **framework** that shapes faith, and the **guardrail** that preserves truth.

Without doctrine, salvation becomes vague. With doctrine, salvation becomes clear, biblical, and transformative.

The next chapter will reveal how the gospel is obeyed through the **New Birth**, the apostolic pattern of salvation.

VII. Summary

1. Salvation is a revealed process grounded in truth; doctrine provides the framework for saving faith and obedience.
2. Doctrine is teaching derived from Scripture that defines the faith, reveals God's plan, and produces obedience.
3. Faith must be anchored in the Word, because hearing truth is necessary to believe correctly.
4. The gospel is both proclaimed and obeyed; doctrine explains how the believer participates through the new birth.
5. Spiritual experience must confirm Scripture, not replace it; the Spirit and the Word always agree.

6. Neglecting doctrine produces deception, division, and powerlessness; sound teaching preserves unity and apostolic authority.

VIII. Study Questions

1. How does Romans 10:14–17 show the relationship between preaching, hearing, faith, and salvation?
 2. Define “doctrine” in your own words based on this chapter.
 3. Why is “experience without doctrine” spiritually dangerous?
 4. What does it mean to “obey the gospel” (2 Thessalonians 1:8), and how is that obedience expressed?
 5. How can a church test spiritual experiences to ensure they align with Scripture?
 6. What are the long-term effects of doctrinal drift on unity and spiritual power?
-

IX. Ministry / Application

1. For teachers: Make “doctrine → obedience” explicit: connect each truth taught to a required response in Scripture.

2. For preachers: Guard the altar call by preaching clearly what Scripture commands, not merely what people feel.

3. For discipleship: Train new believers to test experiences by the Word (Acts 17:11) and to value truth over emotion.

4. For leaders: Establish a church-wide teaching plan that repeats foundational doctrines regularly to prevent drift.

X. Memory Verse

1. Romans 6:17 — “But God be thanked, that ye were the servants of sin, but ye have obeyed from the heart that form of doctrine which was delivered you.”

SECTION II

CORE DOCTRINES OF THE APOSTOLIC CHURCH

This section presents the central doctrines that define the identity, message, and mission of the Apostolic church. These teachings reveal who God is, what He has done through Christ, how salvation is received, and how believers are called to live. From the Oneness of God to the hope of eternity, these doctrines form the theological backbone of Apostolic faith and practice. They are not theoretical ideas but living truths that shape the church's worship, holiness, mission, and daily life.

Chapter 4 — The Oneness of God

The Absolute, Indivisible Identity of the God of Scripture

Chapter 4 — The Oneness of God

The Absolute, Indivisible Identity of the God of Scripture

I. Introduction: The Central Doctrine of the Bible

The doctrine of the Oneness of God is the foundation of all biblical revelation. Every command, covenant, prophecy, and act of redemption flows from the identity of the one true God.

Israel's first and greatest confession remains the anchor of apostolic faith:

“Hear, O Israel: The LORD our God is one LORD.” (Deuteronomy 6:4)

Jesus affirmed this truth (Mark 12:29). The apostles preached it (1 Corinthians 8:4–6). The early church lived it, worshiped it, and proclaimed it.

The Oneness of God is not a theological option—it is the core of biblical monotheism and the heart of apostolic doctrine.

II. The Biblical Revelation of One God

1. God Is Absolutely One

Scripture presents God as singular, unique, and indivisible.

- *“I am the LORD, and there is none else.”* (Isaiah 45:5)
- *“Before Me there was no God formed, neither shall there be after Me.”* (Isaiah 43:10)

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- *“There is none beside Me.”* (Isaiah 45:6)

Biblical monotheism is not numerical reduction—it is absolute exclusivity.

2. God Is Spirit

God is not a plurality of persons; He is Spirit (John 4:24). Spirit is not divided, multiplied, or segmented. God’s essence is singular.

3. God Reveals Himself in Many Ways, but He Is One

Throughout Scripture, God reveals Himself through various roles, titles, and manifestations—yet He remains absolutely one in essence and identity.

• Creator

- *“In the beginning God created the heaven and the earth.”* (Genesis 1:1)
- *“I am the LORD... that stretcheth forth the heavens alone; that spreadeth abroad the earth by Myself.”* (Isaiah 44:24)
- All things were created **by and for Christ** (Colossians 1:16).

• Father

- *“Thou, O LORD, art our Father.”* (Isaiah 63:16)
- *“Have we not all one Father?”* (Malachi 2:10)
- *“He that hath seen Me hath seen the Father.”* (John 14:9)

• Redeemer

- *“Thus saith the LORD... thy Redeemer.”* (Isaiah 44:6)
- *“Our Redeemer, the LORD of hosts is His name.”* (Isaiah 47:4)
- Jesus Christ redeems us (Titus 2:13–14).

One God in Jesus Christ

• Shepherd

- *“The LORD is my shepherd.”* (Psalm 23:1)
- *“He shall feed His flock like a shepherd.”* (Isaiah 40:11)
- *“I am the good shepherd.”* (John 10:11)

• King

- *“God is the King of all the earth.”* (Psalm 47:7)
- *“The LORD shall be King over all the earth.”* (Zechariah 14:9)
- Jesus is *“KING OF KINGS, AND LORD OF LORDS.”* (Revelation 19:16)

• Judge

- *“The LORD is our judge.”* (Isaiah 33:22)
- *“Shall not the Judge of all the earth do right?”* (Genesis 18:25)
- *“The Father... hath committed all judgment unto the Son.”* (John 5:22)

• Savior

- *“Beside Me there is no savior.”* (Isaiah 43:11)
- *“There is no savior beside Me.”* (Hosea 13:4)
- *“A Savior, which is Christ the Lord.”* (Luke 2:11)

These roles do not indicate multiple divine persons; they are expressions of the one God at work.

III. Jesus Christ: The Full Revelation of the One God

One God in Jesus Christ

The identity of Jesus Christ is the central revelation of Scripture. In Him, the invisible God becomes visible, the eternal God becomes incarnate, and the one God of the Old Testament is revealed in flesh.

1. Jesus Is the Image of the Invisible God

- *“Who is the image of the invisible God.”* (Colossians 1:15)
- *“In Him dwelleth all the fulness of the Godhead bodily.”* (Colossians 2:9)
- *“He that hath seen Me hath seen the Father.”* (John 14:9)

2. Jesus Is the Father Revealed in Flesh

- *“I and My Father are one.”* (John 10:30)
- *“He that hath seen Me hath seen the Father.”* (John 14:9)
- *“The Father that dwelleth in Me, He doeth the works.”* (John 14:10)
- *“The mighty God, The everlasting Father.”* (Isaiah 9:6)

3. Jesus Is the Son According to the Flesh

- *“The Holy Ghost shall come upon thee... therefore that holy thing... shall be called the Son of God.”* (Luke 1:35)
- *“When the fulness of the time was come, God sent forth His Son, made of a woman.”* (Galatians 4:4)
- *“God was manifest in the flesh.”* (1 Timothy 3:16)

4. Jesus Is the Name of the Father, Son, and Holy Ghost

- *“Baptizing them in the name...”* (Matthew 28:19)
- *“Be baptized... in the name of Jesus Christ.”* (Acts 2:38)
- *“Baptized in the name of the Lord Jesus.”* (Acts 8:16; Acts 19:5)

One God in Jesus Christ

- *“Baptized in the name of the Lord.”* (Acts 10:48)
-

IV. The Holy Ghost: God in Spiritual Action

1. The Holy Ghost Is Not a Separate Person

- *“The Spirit of God moved...”* (Genesis 1:2)
- *“Now the Lord is that Spirit.”* (2 Corinthians 3:17)
- *“The Spirit of Christ.”* (Romans 8:9)
- *“I will not leave you comfortless: I will come to you.”* (John 14:18)

2. The Spirit Reveals Christ, Not Another Person

- *“He shall teach you all things.”* (John 14:26)
 - *“He shall testify of Me.”* (John 15:26)
 - *“He shall glorify Me.”* (John 16:13–14)
-

V. The Oneness Message in the Apostolic Church

1. The Apostles Preached One God

- *“God hath made that same Jesus... both Lord and Christ.”* (Acts 2:36)
- *“There is none other God but one.”* (1 Corinthians 8:4)
- *“To us there is but one God... and one Lord Jesus Christ.”* (1 Corinthians 8:6)

2. The Apostles Baptized in the Name of Jesus

- Acts 2:38

One God in Jesus Christ

- Acts 8:16
- Acts 10:48
- Acts 19:5
- Romans 6:3
- Galatians 3:27

3. The Apostolic Church Worshiped One God in Christ

- **The Lamb** — John 1:29; Revelation 5:6
 - **The High Priest** — Hebrews 4:14; 7:26–27
 - **The Mediator** — 1 Timothy 2:5; Hebrews 8:6
 - **The King** — Revelation 19:16
 - **The Alpha and Omega** — Revelation 1:8; 22:13
-

VI. Why the Oneness Doctrine Matters

1. It Preserves Biblical Monotheism

- *“I am the LORD, and there is none else.”* (Isaiah 45:5)

2. It Clarifies the Identity of Jesus

- *“God was manifest in the flesh.”* (1 Timothy 3:16)

3. It Anchors the Gospel

Only if Jesus is both God and man can His death and resurrection save.

4. It Protects the Church From Doctrinal Corruption

Truth about God is the foundation of all truth.

One God in Jesus Christ

The revelation of who God is leads directly to the revelation of what God has done in Christ — the gospel.

VII. Conclusion: The One God Revealed in Jesus Christ

The God of Abraham, Isaac, and Jacob is the Christ of the New Testament. The Father is revealed in the Son. The Spirit is God working in His people. There is one God, and His name is Jesus.

VIII. Summary

1. The Oneness of God is the central confession of Scripture: the LORD is one, unique, and incomparable.
 2. God is Spirit and therefore not divided into multiple divine persons; His essence and identity remain singular.
 3. The many titles and roles of God (Creator, Father, Redeemer, Shepherd, King, Judge, Savior) are expressions of the one God at work, not separate persons.
 4. Jesus Christ is the full revelation of the one God: the invisible God made visible, God manifested in flesh.
 5. The apostolic church preached one God in Christ, baptized in the name of Jesus, and worshiped the one God revealed in Jesus.
-

IX. Study Questions

1. How does Deuteronomy 6:4 function as the foundational confession of biblical monotheism?

One God in Jesus Christ

2. Why does the statement “God is Spirit” (John 4:24) matter for understanding the Oneness of God?
 3. How do God’s titles and roles in Scripture reveal His work without implying multiple divine persons?
 4. Which passages in this chapter most clearly identify Jesus as the revelation of the one God, and why?
 5. How should the Oneness doctrine shape the church’s worship, prayer, and preaching?
-

X. Ministry / Application

1. For teachers: Begin a lesson on God with Deuteronomy 6:4 and trace how the New Testament reveals this same one God in Jesus Christ.

2. For preachers: Preach Christ as the full revelation of God, ensuring every sermon makes God’s identity clear—not assumed.

3. For discipleship: Have new believers study John 14:7–11 and explain in their own words what it means to “see the Father” in Jesus.

4. For the church: Pray and worship with intentional Oneness language, exalting Jesus as the one true God revealed to us.

XI. Memory Verse

1. Deuteronomy 6:4 — “Hear, O Israel: The LORD our God is one LORD:”

Chapter 5 — The Gospel of Jesus Christ

The Saving Work of God Revealed in the Death,
Burial, and Resurrection of Jesus

Chapter 5 — The Gospel of Jesus Christ

The Saving Work of God Revealed in the Death, Burial, and Resurrection of Jesus

I. Introduction: The Gospel Is the Power of God

The gospel is not a religious idea, a moral philosophy, or a spiritual feeling. It is the **power of God unto salvation** (Romans 1:16). The gospel is the central message of Scripture and the foundation of the apostolic church.

Paul defines the gospel clearly:

- **Christ died for our sins**
- **He was buried**
- **He rose again the third day**
(1 Corinthians 15:1–4)

The gospel is the revelation of what God has done for humanity through Jesus Christ. It is the message that saves, transforms, and restores.

II. The Gospel In The New Testament

The gospel is revealed clearly in the New Testament, but its authority and foundation rest firmly on the prophetic promises of the Old Testament, especially the writings of Isaiah. The coming Messiah was foretold with precision, describing His birth, ministry, suffering, and triumph.

One God in Jesus Christ

Isaiah's prophecies provide the backbone for understanding the gospel message. For example:

- The virgin birth foretold: *“Therefore the Lord himself shall give you a sign; Behold, a virgin shall conceive, and bear a son, and shall call his name Immanuel.”* (Isaiah 7:14)
- The suffering servant who bears our sins: *“But he was wounded for our transgressions, he was bruised for our iniquities: the chastisement of our peace was upon him; and with his stripes we are healed.”* (Isaiah 53:5)
- The Messiah's mission to bring good news: *“The Spirit of the Lord GOD is upon me; because the LORD hath anointed me to preach good tidings unto the meek; he hath sent me to bind up the brokenhearted, to proclaim liberty to the captives, and the opening of the prison to them that are bound;”* (Isaiah 61:1)

Paul and the apostles consistently pointed back to these Scriptures to confirm that Jesus Christ fulfilled the Old Testament promises, grounding the gospel not merely in their testimony but in the prophetic Word of God.

III. The Gospel Begins With God's Love

The gospel is rooted in the character of God. Salvation does not begin with human effort but with divine initiative.

- *“For God so loved the world, that He gave His only begotten Son.”* (John 3:16)
- *“God commendeth His love toward us, in that, while we were yet sinners, Christ died for us.”* (Romans 5:8)

God's love is not passive—it acts, gives, and sacrifices. The gospel is the ultimate expression of that love.

IV. The Death of Jesus Christ: Atonement for Sin

The death of Jesus is not symbolic. It is substitutionary, sacrificial, and redemptive.

1. Jesus Died for Our Sins

- *“Christ died for our sins according to the Scriptures.”* (1 Corinthians 15:3)
- *“The LORD hath laid on Him the iniquity of us all.”* (Isaiah 53:6)

2. His Blood Brings Redemption

- *“Without shedding of blood is no remission.”* (Hebrews 9:22)
- *“We have redemption through His blood.”* (Ephesians 1:7)

3. His Death Reconciles Us to God

- *“We were reconciled to God by the death of His Son.”* (Romans 5:10)

The cross is where justice and mercy meet. Jesus took our place so we could receive His life.

V. The Burial of Jesus Christ: The Finality of His Sacrifice

The burial of Jesus is not a minor detail—it is a doctrinal necessity.

- *“He was buried.”* (1 Corinthians 15:4)
- *“We are buried with Him by baptism into death.”* (Romans 6:4)

Burial signifies completion. The old life ends. The penalty is paid. The sacrifice is finished.

VI. The Resurrection of Jesus Christ: Victory Over Death

The resurrection is the triumph of God over sin, death, and hell.

1. Jesus Rose on the Third Day

- *“He rose again the third day according to the Scriptures.”* (1 Corinthians 15:4)

2. The Resurrection Declares His Identity

- *“Declared to be the Son of God with power... by the resurrection from the dead.”* (Romans 1:4)

3. The Resurrection Brings New Life

- *“Because I live, ye shall live also.”* (John 14:19)

The resurrection is not only an event—it is the source of new life for every believer.

VII. The Gospel Must Be Obeyed

The gospel is not only believed—it is obeyed.

Paul warns:

- *“The Lord Jesus shall be revealed... taking vengeance on them that obey not the gospel.”* (2 Thessalonians 1:8)

How is the gospel obeyed? Through the new birth experience:

- **Death** → Repentance (Romans 6:6; Acts 2:38)
- **Burial** → Baptism in Jesus’ Name (Romans 6:4; Acts 2:38)

One God in Jesus Christ

- **Resurrection** → Receiving the Holy Ghost (Romans 8:11; Acts 2:4)

Obedying the gospel is not works—it is response to grace.

VIII. The Gospel Is for All People

The gospel is universal in scope and personal in application.

- *“Go ye into all the world, and preach the gospel to every creature.”* (Mark 16:15)
- *“Whosoever shall call on the name of the Lord shall be saved.”* (Acts 2:21)

No culture, nation, or background is excluded. The gospel is God’s invitation to the world.

Because the gospel must be obeyed, the next chapter reveals how Scripture defines that obedience through the new birth.

IX. Conclusion: The Gospel Is the Center of Apostolic Faith

The gospel is the heartbeat of the church. It is the message that saves, the truth that transforms, and the power that sustains.

Jesus died. Jesus was buried. Jesus rose again.

This is the gospel.

This is our hope.

This is the message we preach.

X. Summary

1. The gospel is the power of God unto salvation and is defined by the death, burial, and resurrection of Jesus Christ.
 2. The gospel is rooted in God's love and divine initiative, not in human effort or merit.
 3. The cross provides atonement and reconciliation through the blood of Jesus Christ, where justice and mercy meet.
 4. The burial and resurrection of Jesus are essential to the gospel, declaring the finality of His sacrifice and victory over death.
 5. The gospel must be obeyed through the apostolic new birth response, and it is offered to all people without distinction.
-

XI. Study Questions

1. How does 1 Corinthians 15:1–4 define the gospel, and why must the church keep that definition clear?
 2. What does it mean that the gospel “begins with God's love,” and how does that shape our preaching?
 3. Why is the death of Jesus described as substitutionary and redemptive, and what does His blood accomplish?
 4. How does Romans 6 connect the gospel (death, burial, resurrection) to the believer's response?
 5. In what ways should the universality of the gospel shape the church's mission and outreach?
-

XII. Ministry / Application

1. **For teachers:** Teach the gospel as both message and pattern—show how death, burial, and resurrection connect directly to repentance, baptism, and Spirit infilling.

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2. For preachers: Keep Christ's saving work central—avoid sermons that drift into morality without the cross and resurrection.

3. For discipleship: Ask new believers to write a one-paragraph definition of the gospel using 1 Corinthians 15:1–4 and Romans 6:4.

4. For the church: Identify one person or community your church tends to overlook and intentionally bring the gospel to them.

XIII. Memory Verse

1. Romans 1:16 — “For I am not ashamed of the gospel of Christ: for it is the power of God unto salvation to every one that believeth; to the Jew first, and also to the Greek.”

Chapter 6 — The New Birth

Repentance • Water Baptism in Jesus' Name •
Infilling of the Holy Ghost • The New Life

Chapter 6 — The New Birth

*Repentance • Water Baptism in Jesus' Name •
Infilling of the Holy Ghost • The New Life*

I. Introduction: The New Birth Is the Apostolic Response to the Gospel

The gospel reveals what God has done for humanity through the death, burial, and resurrection of Jesus Christ. The New Birth reveals how humanity responds to that gospel. Jesus declared that the new birth is not optional but essential:

“Except a man be born of water and of the Spirit, he cannot enter into the kingdom of God.” (John 3:5)

The New Birth is not a symbolic ritual, a denominational tradition, or a spiritual metaphor. It is the biblical pattern of salvation preached by Jesus, proclaimed by the apostles, and practiced by the early church. It is the believer's participation in the gospel:

- **Death → Repentance**
- **Burial → Water baptism in Jesus' name**
- **Resurrection → Infilling of the Holy Ghost**

This chapter establishes the doctrinal foundation for the New Birth and its essential components.

II. Repentance: Death to the Old Life

1. Repentance Is Commanded by God

Repentance is not optional. It is the first response to the gospel.

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- “Repent ye, and believe the gospel.” (Mark 1:15)
- “Except ye repent, ye shall all likewise perish.” (Luke 13:3)

Repentance is the believer’s death to sin — the turning of the heart, mind, and will toward God.

2. Repentance Is More Than Emotion

Repentance is not merely feeling sorry. It is a decisive turning.

- Godly sorrow produces repentance (2 Corinthians 7:10), but sorrow itself is not repentance.

Repentance involves:

- **Confession** — acknowledging sin
- **Contrition** — grieving sin
- **Conversion** — turning from sin

3. Repentance Is Seeing God Rightly and Seeing Ourselves Truthfully

Repentance begins with **revelation** — not of sin alone, but of **God Himself**. When Scripture reveals the holiness, perfection, and righteousness of God, it simultaneously exposes the imperfection and brokenness of humanity.

Repentance is seeing and accepting our imperfections against the perfect and holy God as revealed in the Scriptures. It is man saying:

“Lord, You are perfect and I am not. Let me live in Your likeness.”

This is why repentance is not merely sorrow — it is surrender. It is the turning of the heart toward the God who calls us to reflect His image.

4. Repentance Is the Death of the Old Nature

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Paul wrote:

- “Our old man is crucified with Him.” (Romans 6:6)

Repentance is the believer’s participation in Christ’s death. It is the end of the old life and the beginning of transformation.

III. Water Baptism in Jesus’ Name: Burial With Christ

1. Baptism Is Essential to Salvation

Baptism is not a public symbol or outward testimony. It is a biblical requirement.

- “He that believeth and is baptized shall be saved.” (Mark 16:16)
- “Except a man be born of water...” (John 3:5)

The apostles never treated baptism as optional.

2. Baptism Is Burial With Christ

Paul declares:

- “We are buried with Him by baptism into death.” (Romans 6:4)

Baptism is the believer’s participation in Christ’s burial. The old life is buried; the new life begins.

IV. The Name of Jesus — The Only Biblical Formula

Every baptism in the New Testament is performed **in the name of Jesus Christ**. This is not a denominational preference — it is the apostolic pattern.

1. The Apostolic Command

One God in Jesus Christ

- “Be baptized... in the name of Jesus Christ.” (Acts 2:38)

2. The Samaritan Revival

- “They were baptized in the name of the Lord Jesus.” (Acts 8:16)

3. Cornelius and His Household

- “He commanded them to be baptized in the name of the Lord.” (Acts 10:48)

4. The Disciples of John

- “They were baptized in the name of the Lord Jesus.” (Acts 19:5)

There is **no biblical record** of anyone being baptized using the titles “Father, Son, and Holy Ghost.”

5. The Name Revealed in Matthew 28:19

Jesus said:

- “Baptizing them in the name...” (Matthew 28:19)

The apostles understood that **name** to be Jesus. They obeyed Matthew 28:19 by baptizing in the name that holds all divine authority.

V. Why the Name Matters — Authority, Identity, and Covenant

1. The Name Carries Authority

- “Whatsoever ye do in word or deed, do all in the name of the Lord Jesus.” (Colossians 3:17)

Baptism is both word and deed — therefore it must be done in His name.

2. The Name Is Where Salvation Is Found

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- “There is none other name... whereby we must be saved.”
(Acts 4:12)

Salvation is inseparable from the name of Jesus.

3. The Name Is the Fulfillment of the Father, Son, and Spirit

Jesus is:

- **The Father revealed** (John 14:9)
- **The Son in flesh** (Matthew 1:21)
- **The Holy Ghost in action** (John 14:18)

The name of Jesus is the fullness of God revealed. To invoke His name in baptism is to enter covenant with the one true God.

VI. The Infilling of the Holy Ghost: Resurrection Power

1. The Holy Ghost Is the Promise of the Father

Jesus promised:

- “Ye shall receive power, after that the Holy Ghost is come upon you.” (Acts 1:8)

The Spirit is not optional — it is the promised gift of God.

2. The Evidence of the Holy Ghost Is Speaking in Tongues

Every recorded instance of Spirit infilling in Acts includes speaking in tongues:

- Acts 2:4
- Acts 10:44–46
- Acts 19:6

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Tongues are not the goal; they are the evidence. The Spirit's infilling is the believer's participation in Christ's resurrection life.

3. The Spirit Gives Power to Live a New Life

The Holy Ghost:

- regenerates (Titus 3:5)
- empowers (Acts 1:8)
- sanctifies (Romans 8:13)
- guides into truth (John 16:13)

The Spirit is Christ in us — the hope of glory (Colossians 1:27).

VII. The New Life: Walking in the Spirit

1. The New Birth Produces a New Identity

Those who are born again are:

- new creatures (2 Corinthians 5:17)
- children of God (Romans 8:14–16)
- citizens of the kingdom (John 3:5)

2. The New Birth Produces a New Lifestyle

The Spirit empowers believers to:

- walk in holiness (1 Peter 1:15–16)
- bear spiritual fruit (Galatians 5:22–23)
- live in righteousness (Romans 6:18)

3. The New Birth Produces a New Mission

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Those who are born again become witnesses of Christ.

- “Ye shall be witnesses unto Me.” (Acts 1:8)

The new life is not passive — it is a Spirit-empowered calling.

The new birth not only saves — it transforms. This transformation is expressed through a life of holiness.

VIII. Conclusion: The New Birth Is the Apostolic Pattern of Salvation

The New Birth is the biblical response to the gospel. It is the pattern Jesus taught, the apostles preached, and the early church practiced.

- **Repentance** — death to sin
- **Baptism in Jesus’ name** — burial with Christ
- **Infilling of the Holy Ghost** — resurrection life
- **The new life** — walking in the Spirit

This is the apostolic message. This is the apostolic pattern. This is the way of salvation revealed in Scripture.

IX. Summary

1. The New Birth is the apostolic response to the gospel and is required for entrance into the kingdom of God (John 3:5).

2. Repentance is death to the old life: a commanded turning to God that involves surrender, conversion, and participation in Christ’s death (Mark 1:15; Romans 6:6).

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3. Water baptism is burial with Christ and is essential to salvation, not merely a symbol (Romans 6:4; Mark 16:16).

4. The apostolic church baptized in the name of Jesus Christ, the revealed saving name with divine authority (Acts 2:38; Acts 4:12).

5. The Holy Ghost is resurrection power in the believer, evidenced in Acts by speaking with other tongues, and empowers a new life and mission (Acts 2:4; Acts 1:8).

6. The New Birth produces a new identity, a new lifestyle, and a Spirit-empowered witness.

X. Study Questions

1. How does John 3:5 define the New Birth, and why is it presented as essential rather than optional?
2. What is the difference between repentance and sorrow, and how does true repentance participate in Christ's death (Romans 6:6)?
3. How does Romans 6 connect baptism to the gospel, and why does Scripture call it "burial" with Christ?
4. Why did the apostles consistently baptize in the name of Jesus, and how does Acts 4:12 explain the importance of the name?
5. What evidence in the Book of Acts is repeatedly connected to receiving the Holy Ghost, and what purpose does the Spirit give to believers (Acts 1:8)?

XI. Ministry / Application

1. For teachers: Teach the New Birth as the believer's participation in the gospel (death, burial, resurrection), showing the scriptural connections clearly.

One God in Jesus Christ

2. For preachers: Preach repentance as surrender and transformation, not merely regret, and call for obedience to the apostolic pattern.

3. For baptism ministers: Ensure every baptism is performed in the name of Jesus Christ with clear explanation of covenant identity and remission of sins.

4. For discipleship: Help new believers establish Spirit-filled habits (prayer, Word, holiness, witness) as the normal outworking of the New Birth.

XII. Memory Verse

1. John 3:5 — “Jesus answered, Verily, verily, I say unto thee, except a man be born of water and of the Spirit, he cannot enter into the kingdom of God.”

Chapter 7 — Holiness and Sanctification

Identity • Separation • Transformation •
Christlike Living in a Modern World

Chapter 7 — Holiness and Sanctification

Identity • Separation • Transformation • Christlike Living in a Modern World

I. Introduction: Holiness Is the Will of God for Every Believer

Holiness is not an optional pursuit or a special calling for a select few. It is the will of God for every person who has been born again.

- “Follow peace with all men, and holiness, without which no man shall see the Lord.” (Hebrews 12:14)
- “This is the will of God, even your sanctification.” (1 Thessalonians 4:3)

Holiness is the natural result of the new birth. Those who have died with Christ, been buried with Christ, and risen with Christ must now walk with Christ in newness of life.

Holiness is not bondage — it is freedom. It is the life of the Spirit formed in the people of God.

II. Holiness as Identity — God’s Character Revealed in His People

1. God Is Holy

Holiness begins with God Himself.

- “Be ye holy; for I am holy.” (1 Peter 1:16)
- “Who is like unto thee, glorious in holiness?” (Exodus 15:11)

Holiness is not first about behavior — it is about identity.

2. Holiness Is God’s Nature in Us

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Holiness is God's life expressed through His people.

- “Partakers of His holiness.” (Hebrews 12:10)
- “Christ in you, the hope of glory.” (Colossians 1:27)

Holiness is not human effort — it is divine nature.

3. Holiness Is the Evidence of the New Birth

A holy God produces a holy people.

- “Follow... holiness, without which no man shall see the Lord.” (Hebrews 12:14)

Holiness is the visible expression of an inward transformation. It is Christ formed in us.

III. Sanctification — A Work of the Spirit and a Walk of Obedience

1. Instant Sanctification — Set Apart by God

At conversion, God sets us apart for Himself.

- “Ye are washed... ye are sanctified... in the name of the Lord Jesus, and by the Spirit of our God.” (1 Corinthians 6:11)

Sanctification begins with God's act of grace.

2. Progressive Sanctification — Growing in Christ

Sanctification continues throughout life.

- “Grow in grace.” (2 Peter 3:18)
- “Be renewed in the spirit of your mind.” (Ephesians 4:23)

Holiness deepens as we walk with God.

3. Sanctification Requires Obedience

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Holiness is both a gift and a pursuit.

- “As obedient children...” (1 Peter 1:14)
- “Present your bodies a living sacrifice.” (Romans 12:1)

The Spirit empowers, but the believer obeys.

IV. Separation Unto God — Distinct in Identity and Lifestyle

1. Called Out of Darkness

Holiness requires separation from the world’s values and sinful practices.

- “He hath called you out of darkness into His marvellous light.” (1 Peter 2:9)

2. Separation Is Commanded

Separation is not optional.

- “Come out from among them and be ye separate.” (2 Corinthians 6:17)

3. Friendship With the World Is Enmity With God

The world’s system is opposed to God.

- “Whosoever therefore will be a friend of the world is the enemy of God.” (James 4:4)

Separation is not isolation — it is distinction. It is belonging to God.

V. Holiness in the Heart — The Inner Life

Holiness begins internally before it is expressed externally.

One God in Jesus Christ

1. Pure Thoughts

- “Think on these things.” (Philippians 4:8)

2. Pure Motives

- “The Lord looketh on the heart.” (1 Samuel 16:7)

3. Pure Desires

- “Set your affection on things above.” (Colossians 3:2)

Holiness is first a matter of the heart.

VI. Holiness in Conduct — The Outer Life

The inner work of the Spirit produces visible transformation.

1. Holy Speech

- “Let no corrupt communication proceed out of your mouth.” (Ephesians 4:29)

2. Holy Actions

- “Abstain from all appearance of evil.” (1 Thessalonians 5:22)

3. Holy Relationships

- “Be ye kind one to another.” (Ephesians 4:32)

Holiness is lived out in daily behavior.

VII. Holiness in Appearance — Reflecting God’s Order and Identity

Holiness includes the body, because the body is the temple of the Holy Ghost.

One God in Jesus Christ

1. The Body Belongs to God

- “Ye are bought with a price: therefore glorify God in your body.” (1 Corinthians 6:20)

2. Modesty and Distinction

- “Adorn themselves in modest apparel.” (1 Timothy 2:9)

3. Gender Distinction

- “Male and female created He them.” (Genesis 1:27)

Holiness in appearance reflects God’s design, identity, and order. Outward appearance reveals inward identity.

VIII. Holiness and the Spirit — Empowered to Live Differently

Holiness is not achieved by human effort alone. It is empowered by the Spirit.

1. The Spirit Enables Victory

- “Walk in the Spirit, and ye shall not fulfil the lust of the flesh.” (Galatians 5:16)

2. The Spirit Produces Fruit

- “The fruit of the Spirit is love, joy, peace...” (Galatians 5:22–23)

3. The Spirit Leads Into Holiness

- “As many as are led by the Spirit of God...” (Romans 8:14)

Holiness is Spirit-empowered transformation.

IX. Holiness in a Modern World

One God in Jesus Christ

1. Holiness Is Still Possible

The modern world is saturated with immorality, materialism, and moral confusion — but holiness is eternal.

2. Holiness Is Counter-Cultural

The church confronts the world by contrast:

- purity in impurity
- humility in pride
- truth in relativism
- identity in confusion

Holiness is the church's prophetic witness.

3. Holiness Requires Discernment

Modern challenges require Spirit-led wisdom:

- media
- entertainment
- relationships
- technology
- cultural trends

Holiness is not avoidance — it is discernment.

4. Holiness Is Freedom, Not Restriction

Holiness is not bondage — sin is bondage. Holiness is liberation.

X. The Purpose of Holiness — Witness, Worship, and Identity

One God in Jesus Christ

1. Holiness Is Our Witness

- “Let your light so shine before men.” (Matthew 5:16)

2. Holiness Is Our Worship

- “Present your bodies a living sacrifice... which is your reasonable service.” (Romans 12:1)

3. Holiness Is Our Identity

- “A chosen generation... an holy nation.” (1 Peter 2:9)

Holiness reveals who we belong to.

Holiness forms the character of the believer; the church forms the community in which that holiness is lived.

XI. Conclusion: Holiness Is the Life of the Spirit in the People of God

Holiness is:

- God’s nature in us
- The fruit of the new birth
- The evidence of transformation
- The lifestyle of the kingdom
- The identity of the apostolic church

Holiness is not bondage — it is freedom. Not restriction — but restoration. Not human effort — but divine life.

A life of holiness is a life of freedom, and it is one of the best gifts given to the new man; he is now a free man — free to walk in the likeness of his holy God and no longer a slave to sin.

XII. Summary

1. Holiness is the will of God for every believer and the necessary pursuit of those who have been born again (Hebrews 12:14).
 2. Holiness begins with identity: God is holy, and He forms His character in His people by His Spirit (1 Peter 1:15–16).
 3. Sanctification is both God’s setting-apart work and the believer’s lifelong growth in obedience, empowered by grace.
 4. Separation is commanded and produces distinction; believers belong to God and must refuse worldliness without abandoning mission.
 5. Holiness must be inward and outward—heart, conduct, appearance—because the whole life is yielded to God.
 6. The Spirit enables victory and fruitfulness, making holiness freedom rather than bondage.
-

XIII. Study Questions

1. Why does Scripture connect holiness to seeing the Lord (Hebrews 12:14), and how should that shape a believer’s priorities?
2. What is the difference between holiness as identity and holiness as behavior, and why are both necessary?
3. How do instant sanctification and progressive sanctification work together in a believer’s life?
4. What is biblical separation, and how can a believer remain distinct without becoming isolated?
5. How does the Holy Ghost empower holiness, and what practices help believers “walk in the Spirit” (Galatians 5:16)?

XIV. Ministry / Application

1. For teachers: Teach holiness from Scripture as identity and obedience, emphasizing transformation rather than external conformity alone.

2. For leaders: Model holiness with transparency and compassion, building a church culture where conviction is paired with shepherding.

3. For discipleship: Help believers identify one area of worldliness to surrender and replace it with a Spirit-led practice (prayer, Word, service).

4. For the church: Teach holiness as witness—let conduct, speech, and relationships display the character of Christ to a confused world.

XV. Memory Verse

1. Hebrews 12:14 — “Follow peace with all men, and holiness, without which no man shall see the Lord:”

Chapter 8 — The Church

Identity • Authority • Mission • The Church in
the Last Days

Chapter 8 — The Church

Identity • Authority • Mission • The Church in the Last Days

I. Introduction: The Church Is God's Covenant Community

The church is not a building, an organization, or a religious institution. It is the redeemed people of God — called out, set apart, and joined together by the Spirit.

“I will build My church; and the gates of hell shall not prevail against it.” (Matthew 16:18)

The church belongs to Christ. It is founded on Christ. It is empowered by Christ. It exists for the glory of Christ.

The church is the visible expression of God's kingdom on earth.

II. The Identity of the Church

1. The Church Is the Called-Out People of God

The word *church* (ekklesia) means “the called-out ones.”

- Called out of darkness (1 Peter 2:9)
- Called into His marvelous light
- Called into fellowship with Christ (1 Corinthians 1:9)

The church is a people separated unto God.

2. The Church Is the Body of Christ

The church is not merely associated with Christ — it is His body.

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- “Now ye are the body of Christ.” (1 Corinthians 12:27)

Christ is the Head; the church is His living expression on earth.

3. The Church Is the Bride of Christ

The church is loved, redeemed, and sanctified by Christ.

- “Christ also loved the church, and gave Himself for it.”
(Ephesians 5:25)

The church is His covenant partner, awaiting His return.

4. The Church Is a Holy Nation

The church is God’s new covenant people.

- “A chosen generation... an holy nation.” (1 Peter 2:9)

Identity shapes purpose. The church is who God says it is — not what the world imagines it to be.

III. Authority and Order in the Church

1. Christ Is the Head of the Church

All authority flows from Him.

- “He is the head of the body, the church.” (Colossians 1:18)

No human leader replaces Christ’s authority.

2. The Apostles’ Doctrine Is the Foundation

The early church continued steadfastly in:

- the apostles’ doctrine
- fellowship

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- breaking of bread
- prayers
(Acts 2:42)

The church is built on the foundation of the apostles and prophets, with Jesus Christ as the chief cornerstone (Ephesians 2:20).

3. God Ordained Spiritual Leadership

Christ gave:

- apostles
- prophets
- evangelists
- pastors
- teachers
(Ephesians 4:11)

Their purpose:

- perfecting the saints
- work of ministry
- edifying the body
- unity of the faith
- maturity in Christ

Authority in the church is not domination — it is service.

4. Order Protects the Church

God is not the author of confusion (1 Corinthians 14:33). Order ensures:

One God in Jesus Christ

- unity
- clarity
- accountability
- spiritual health

A church without order becomes a church without direction.

IV. The Mission of the Church

1. The Church Is Called to Preach the Gospel

The Great Commission is the church's primary mandate.

- “Go ye into all the world, and preach the gospel.” (Mark 16:15)

The church exists to proclaim Christ.

2. The Church Is Called to Make Disciples

Evangelism is not complete without discipleship.

- “Teach all nations... teaching them to observe all all things.”
(Matthew 28:19–20)

The church forms believers into mature followers of Jesus.

3. The Church Is Called to Demonstrate the Kingdom

The church reveals God's reign through:

- holiness
- unity
- love
- spiritual gifts

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- good works
- compassion

The world sees Christ through His church.

4. The Church Is Called to Worship

Worship is not an event — it is identity.

- “Ye are... a royal priesthood... to show forth the praises of Him.” (1 Peter 2:9)

The church exists to glorify God.

V. The Church in the Last Days

1. The Church Will Face Pressure

Scripture warns of:

- deception
- persecution
- false doctrine
- spiritual coldness
- lawlessness

The last-days church must be anchored in truth.

2. The Church Will Experience Revival

In the last days, God promised:

- an outpouring of the Spirit (Joel 2:28)
- a harvest of souls

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- signs and wonders
- global evangelism

The last-days church is not weak — it is victorious.

3. The Church Must Remain Faithful

Jesus asked:

- “When the Son of man cometh, shall He find faith on the earth?” (Luke 18:8)

The last-days church must:

- hold fast to doctrine
- walk in holiness
- endure hardship
- remain steadfast
- love truth

4. The Church Will Be Caught Away

The blessed hope of the church is the return of Christ.

- “The dead in Christ shall rise first... then we which are alive... shall be caught up.” (1 Thessalonians 4:16–17)

The church is a pilgrim people — living on earth but destined for glory.

The church lives in mission now, but it also lives in expectation — for Christ is coming again.

VI. Conclusion: The Church Is God’s Witness in the World

The church is:

One God in Jesus Christ

- the body of Christ
- the bride of Christ
- the temple of the Spirit
- the family of God
- the pillar and ground of the truth

The church is God's chosen instrument to reveal His glory, proclaim His gospel, and prepare the world for His return.

The church is not a human idea — it is a divine creation. The church is not fragile — it is victorious. The church is not temporary — it is eternal.

This is the church Jesus built. This is the church empowered by the Spirit. This is the church that will stand until He comes.

VII. Summary

1. The church is God's covenant community—redeemed people, not a building—founded on Christ and belonging to Christ (Matthew 16:18).
2. The church's identity is defined biblically as the called-out people of God, the body of Christ, the bride of Christ, and a holy nation.
3. Authority in the church flows from Christ as Head and is protected by apostolic doctrine, spiritual leadership, and Godly order.
4. The mission of the church is to preach the gospel, make disciples, demonstrate the kingdom, and glorify God through worship and holy living.

One God in Jesus Christ

5. In the last days the church faces pressure and deception yet also experience revival and must remain faithful to truth.

6. The church is God’s witness in the world and will endure until Christ comes, because it is His creation and His work.

VIII. Study Questions

1. Why is it important to define the church as a people rather than as a building or institution?
 2. How do the “body of Christ” and “bride of Christ” images shape how believers should live together?
 3. What does it mean that Christ is Head of the church, and how should that affect leadership and decision-making?
 4. How do preaching, discipleship, holiness, and worship work together in fulfilling the church’s mission?
 5. What pressures does the church face in the last days, and what does faithfulness look like in response?
-

IX. Ministry / Application

1. For leaders: Clarify the church’s identity regularly in teaching—who we are determines how we live and what we prioritize.

2. For teachers: Use Acts 2:42 and Ephesians 4:11–16 to show how doctrine, fellowship, prayer, and leadership work together for maturity.

3. For the church: Strengthen mission by pairing evangelism with discipleship so converts become grounded disciples.

4. For ministry teams: Evaluate programs and practices by apostolic doctrine and purpose—keep what forms Christ, remove what distracts from mission.

X. Memory Verse

1. Matthew 16:18 — “And I say also unto thee, That thou art Peter, and upon this rock I will build my church; and the gates of hell shall not prevail against it.”

Chapter 9 — The Last Things

Death • Resurrection • Judgment • Eternal
Destinies

Chapter 9 — The Last Things

Death • Resurrection • Judgment • Eternal Destinies

I. Introduction: The Final Realities of God's Plan

Biblical doctrine does not end with salvation, holiness, or the church. Scripture points forward to the final consummation of God's purpose — the resurrection of the dead, the judgment of all humanity, and the eternal destinies that follow.

The doctrine of the last things is not speculation. It is revelation — given to produce:

- hope
- sobriety
- holiness
- urgency

Eternity is not symbolic. It is certain.

II. Death

1. Death Is the Separation of Body and Spirit

Scripture teaches that death is the end of earthly life.

- “It is appointed unto men once to die.” (Hebrews 9:27)

2. The Body Returns to the Earth

Death reverses the creation pattern.

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- “The dust returns to the earth as it was.” (Ecclesiastes 12:7)

3. The Spirit Returns to God

Scripture affirms God’s ownership of every human spirit.

- “The spirit shall return unto God who gave it.” (Ecclesiastes 12:7)

4. Scripture Describes Death as “Sleep”

This language emphasizes:

- the temporary nature of death
- the certainty of resurrection
- the rest of the body in the grave

Examples:

- “Them which sleep in Jesus.” (1 Thessalonians 4:14)
- “Many that sleep in the dust shall awake.” (Daniel 12:2)

“Sleep” refers to the **body**, not the final destiny of the person.

Scripture does not describe the experience of the dead in detail. It simply affirms that death is not the end.

III. The Resurrection

1. Christ’s Resurrection Is the Pattern and Guarantee

Jesus is the first to rise never to die again.

- “Christ the firstfruits; afterward they that are Christ’s at His coming.” (1 Corinthians 15:23)

2. The Resurrection of the Righteous

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At the return of Christ:

- “The dead in Christ shall rise first.” (1 Thessalonians 4:16)

This resurrection is unto immortality and glory.

3. The Resurrection of the Unrighteous

Scripture teaches a second resurrection.

- “There shall be a resurrection of the dead, both of the just and unjust.” (Acts 24:15)

4. The Nature of the Resurrection Body

The believer’s resurrected body will be:

- incorruptible
- immortal
- glorious
- powerful

(1 Corinthians 15:42–44)

Resurrection is the restoration and transformation of the whole person.

IV. Judgment

1. The Judgment Seat of Christ

Believers will stand before Christ to give account.

- “We must all appear before the judgment seat of Christ.” (2 Corinthians 5:10)

This judgment concerns:

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- faithfulness
- obedience
- stewardship
- motives

It is not a judgment for salvation, but for reward.

2. The Great White Throne Judgment

The final judgment of the wicked is described in Revelation 20.

- “The dead... stood before God... and the books were opened.”
(Revelation 20:12)

This judgment determines eternal destiny.

3. Judgment Is Righteous and Final

God judges:

- impartially
- truthfully
- according to His Word

No one escapes the justice of God.

V. Eternal Destinies

1. Eternal Life With Christ

The righteous will dwell forever in the presence of God.

- “So shall we ever be with the Lord.” (1 Thessalonians 4:17)

Eternal life includes:

One God in Jesus Christ

- joy
- glory
- worship
- fellowship
- the presence of God

2. Eternal Punishment

Scripture teaches the reality of eternal judgment.

- “These shall go away into everlasting punishment.” (Matthew 25:46)

This is the final consequence of rejecting God.

3. The New Heaven and New Earth

God will renew all things.

- “A new heaven and a new earth.” (Revelation 21:1)

This is the eternal home of the redeemed — a creation without sin, death, or sorrow.

VI. The Urgency of Readiness

1. Christ Will Return Unexpectedly

Jesus warned:

- “In such an hour as ye think not the Son of man cometh.” (Matthew 24:44)

2. The Doctrine of Eternity Produces Holiness

Eternal hope shapes present obedience.

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- “Every man that hath this hope... purifieth himself.” (1 John 3:3)

3. The World Is Moving Toward Judgment

History is not random — it is moving toward a divine conclusion.

4. The Gospel Must Be Preached With Urgency

Eternity is real. Judgment is certain. Souls are eternal.

The church must proclaim the gospel with conviction and compassion.

The doctrines of God, the gospel, the new birth, holiness, the church, and the last things form the core of apostolic faith. These truths shape not only what we believe but how we live as we await His return.

VII. Conclusion: Eternity Gives Meaning to Today

The doctrine of the last things is not meant to satisfy curiosity. It is meant to shape character, mission, and hope.

Eternity reminds us:

- life is short
- judgment is certain
- resurrection is promised
- Christ is coming
- destiny is eternal

This is the hope of the church. This is the warning to the world. This is the anchor of the believer.

VIII. Summary

1. The doctrine of the last things is revelation meant to produce hope, sobriety, holiness, and urgency, because eternity is certain.
 2. Death ends earthly life and separates body and spirit, yet Scripture treats death as temporary in view of resurrection (Hebrews 9:27).
 3. Christ's resurrection is the pattern and guarantee of the believer's resurrection and future glory (1 Corinthians 15:23).
 4. Scripture teaches judgment: believers answer to Christ for reward, and the wicked face final judgment before God (2 Corinthians 5:10; Revelation 20:12).
 5. Eternal destinies are real: eternal life with Christ or everlasting punishment, and God will renew creation for the redeemed (Matthew 25:46; Revelation 21:1).
 6. Readiness is a daily posture—living in holiness and faithful stewardship in light of Christ's sudden return.
-

IX. Study Questions

1. Why is the doctrine of the last things meant to shape character and mission rather than satisfy curiosity?
 2. How does Scripture describe death, and what comfort does the language of “sleep” provide concerning resurrection?
 3. How does Christ's resurrection guarantee the resurrection of believers (1 Corinthians 15:23)?
 4. What is the difference between the judgment seat of Christ and the Great White Throne judgment?
 5. What daily habits help believers live in readiness for Christ's return?
-

X. Ministry / Application

1. For teachers: Teach eschatology with pastoral purpose—connect eternal realities to holiness, perseverance, and evangelism.

2. For preachers: Preach readiness without fearmongering—call people to repentance, faithfulness, and hope centered on Christ.

3. For discipleship: Help believers practice stewardship in light of eternity: time, relationships, ministry, and resources as eternal investments.

4. For the church: Renew urgency in mission—pray for souls and commit to consistent gospel witness because judgment and eternity are real.

XI. Memory Verse

1. Hebrews 9:27 — “And as it is appointed unto men once to die, but after this the judgment:”

SECTION III

MINISTRY IMPLICATIONS OF DOCTRINE

Doctrine is not merely believed — it is lived, preached, taught, and embodied. This section explores how core doctrines shape the ministry of the church. It shows how doctrine forms worship, fuels preaching, guides discipleship, and anchors leadership. These chapters equip ministers, teachers, and workers to handle truth responsibly and to build a church culture that reflects the revelation of Jesus Christ. Doctrine becomes practice, and practice becomes formation.

Chapter 10 — Doctrine and Worship

Worship as Response • Worship in Truth •
Worship Without Manipulation • Worship as
Formation

Chapter 10 — Doctrine and Worship

Worship as Response • Worship in Truth • Worship Without Manipulation • Worship as Formation

I. Introduction: Worship Flows From Revelation

Worship is not an emotional exercise, a musical expression, or a cultural tradition. Worship is the **response of the redeemed** to the revelation of who God is.

Doctrine shapes worship because doctrine reveals God. Where doctrine is shallow, worship becomes shallow. Where doctrine is distorted, worship becomes distorted. Where doctrine is strong, worship becomes strong.

Worship is not built on atmosphere — it is built on truth.

II. Worship as Response to Revelation

1. Worship Begins With God, Not With Us

Biblical worship is always initiated by God's self-disclosure.

- God speaks → we respond
- God reveals → we adore
- God acts → we praise

Worship is not human creativity reaching upward; it is human humility responding to divine revelation.

2. Revelation Produces Awe

Throughout Scripture, whenever God reveals Himself:

One God in Jesus Christ

- Moses removes his shoes
- Isaiah cries “Woe is me”
- John falls as though dead

Worship is not casual. It is the soul’s recognition of God’s holiness, majesty, and glory.

3. Worship Is Rooted in the Knowledge of God

Jesus said:

- “Ye worship ye know not what.” (John 4:22)

Ignorance produces empty worship. Revelation produces true worship.

Doctrine gives worship its content.

III. Worship Aligned With Truth

1. Worship Must Be “in Spirit and in Truth”

Jesus declared:

- “The true worshippers shall worship the Father in spirit and in truth.” (John 4:23)

Worship must be:

- spiritual (from the heart)
- truthful (aligned with Scripture)

Emotion without truth is empty. Truth without response is dead.

2. Worship Must Reflect the Nature of God

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If God is holy, worship must be holy. If God is one, worship must be undivided. If God is righteous, worship must be pure.

Doctrine protects worship from becoming:

- sentimental
- self-centered
- entertainment-driven
- personality-driven

3. Worship Must Be Christ-Centered

Jesus is the full revelation of God. Therefore, worship that does not exalt Christ is not Christian worship.

The name of Jesus is not an optional element — it is the center of worship.

When We Worship the Son, We Glorify the Father

Worship directed to Christ is worship received by the Father, because the Father is revealed in the Son.

- “He that hath seen Me hath seen the Father.” (John 14:9)
- “God was in Christ, reconciling the world unto Himself.” (2 Corinthians 5:19)

When we worship the Son, we acknowledge the Father who manifested Himself in the Son and accomplished salvation through the cross. It was God Himself who fulfilled the work of redemption He promised. Therefore, to honor Christ is to honor the Father who dwelt in Him and acted through Him.

Worship that exalts Jesus is worship that glorifies the Father.

IV. The Dangers of Emotionalism

1. Emotionalism Is Not Worship

Emotion is a natural response to God, but emotion **is not** the measure of worship.

Emotionalism:

- seeks feelings instead of truth
- confuses atmosphere with anointing
- replaces revelation with stimulation
- produces temporary excitement, not lasting transformation

2. Emotionalism Can Manipulate

When worship is driven by:

- music
- lighting
- performance
- hype

it can create an illusion of spirituality without the substance of truth.

Doctrine protects the church from manipulation.

3. Emotionalism Cannot Sustain Faith

Feelings rise and fall. Truth remains.

A church built on emotionalism will be unstable. A church built on doctrine will endure.

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V. Worship as Formation

1. Worship Shapes the Believer

Worship is not only expression — it is formation.

In worship, the believer:

- submits to God
- aligns with truth
- is shaped by holiness
- is strengthened in faith

Worship trains the heart to love what God loves.

2. Worship Shapes the Church

A doctrinally grounded worship culture produces:

- unity
- reverence
- spiritual maturity
- discernment

Worship is not filler in the service — it is formation for the saints.

3. Worship Shapes Mission

A worshipping church is a witnessing church.

When the church sees God clearly, the church proclaims God boldly.

Worship fuels mission because worship reveals worth.

Worship is the church's response to revelation; preaching is the church's proclamation of that revelation.

VI. Conclusion: Doctrine Protects and Purifies Worship

Worship is the highest activity of the church. It is the eternal occupation of the redeemed. It is the rightful response to the revelation of God.

Doctrine ensures that worship remains:

- pure
- holy
- Christ-centered
- truthful
- transformative

Worship that is grounded in doctrine glorifies God and strengthens the church. Worship that is detached from doctrine drifts into error.

True worship is the sound of truth embraced.

VII. Summary

- 1.** Worship is the redeemed response to the revelation of who God is, and therefore worship must be rooted in doctrine.
- 2.** True worship begins with God's self-disclosure and produces reverence, awe, and obedience rather than casual familiarity.
- 3.** Worship must be "in spirit and in truth," aligned with Scripture and centered on Jesus Christ as the revelation of the Father (John 4:23).
- 4.** Emotionalism is not worship and can become manipulation when atmosphere replaces truth and stimulation replaces revelation.

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5. Doctrinal worship forms believers and the church, producing unity, maturity, discernment, and mission.

6. Doctrine protects and purifies worship so it remains holy, Christ-centered, and transformative.

VIII. Study Questions

1. How does doctrine shape worship, and what happens when doctrine is shallow or distorted?
 2. What does it mean to worship “in spirit and in truth” (John 4:23), and why must both be present?
 3. Why must worship be Christ-centered, and how does worship directed to Christ glorify the Father?
 4. What are signs that emotionalism is replacing true worship in a church setting?
 5. How can worship function as formation for believers and mission for the church?
-

IX. Ministry / Application

1. For worship leaders: Choose songs and Scripture readings that clearly express apostolic doctrine—let worship teach truth, not merely generate emotion.

2. For pastors: Guard the worship atmosphere from manipulation by keeping Scripture central and by teaching the church how to worship biblically.

3. For the church: Practice worship as obedience: align daily life (speech, holiness, relationships) with the God you praise publicly.

4. For discipleship: Train believers to connect worship with mission—those who see God clearly should proclaim Him boldly.

X. Memory Verse

1. John 4:23 — “But the hour cometh, and now is, when the true worshippers shall worship the Father in spirit and in truth: for the Father seeketh such to worship him.”

Chapter 11 — Doctrine and Preaching

Preaching as Proclamation • Preaching With Authority • Preaching Rooted in Truth • Preaching That Forms the Church

Chapter 11 — Doctrine and Preaching

Preaching as Proclamation • Preaching With Authority • Preaching Rooted in Truth • Preaching That Forms the Church

I. Introduction: Preaching Is the Voice of Doctrine

Preaching is not motivational speaking, storytelling, or religious commentary. Preaching is the **public proclamation of divine truth**.

Doctrine gives preaching its message. Preaching gives doctrine its voice.

Where doctrine is weak, preaching becomes shallow. Where doctrine is absent, preaching becomes powerless. Where doctrine is strong, preaching becomes authoritative.

Preaching is the church's primary means of declaring the revelation of God.

II. Preaching as Proclamation

1. Preaching Declares What God Has Revealed

The preacher does not invent truth — he announces it.

- “Preach the word.” (2 Timothy 4:2)

Preaching is not:

- opinion
- speculation
- entertainment

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- commentary on culture

Preaching is the heralding of God's Word.

2. Preaching Is Rooted in Scripture

The authority of preaching comes from the text, not the preacher.

The preacher's task is to:

- read the Word
- explain the Word
- apply the Word
- obey the Word

The pulpit is not a platform for creativity — it is a place of revelation.

3. Preaching Must Be Clear and Understandable

Truth must be proclaimed in a way that:

- convicts the sinner
- strengthens the believer
- instructs the simple
- confronts the rebellious

Clarity is not compromise. Clarity is faithfulness.

III. Preaching With Authority

1. Authority Comes From God, Not Personality

A preacher's authority is not based on:

- charisma

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- eloquence
- volume
- style

Authority comes from alignment with God's Word.

Jesus "taught them as one having authority" because He spoke the Father's truth.

2. Authority Requires Conviction

A preacher cannot proclaim what he does not believe.

Conviction is born from:

- prayer
- study
- obedience
- revelation

A sermon without conviction is a speech. A sermon with conviction is a message from God.

3. Authority Requires Holiness

The preacher's life must match his message.

A compromised preacher cannot preach with authority. A holy preacher does not need to force authority — it flows from integrity.

IV. Preaching Rooted in Doctrine

1. Doctrine Gives Preaching Its Content

Preaching must declare:

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- who God is
- what God has done
- what God requires
- what God promises

Doctrine is not optional — it is the substance of preaching.

2. Preaching Must Present the Gospel Clearly

The gospel is not:

- self-improvement
- positive thinking
- moral advice

The gospel is:

- the incarnation
- the cross
- the resurrection
- the outpouring of the Spirit
- the call to repentance
- the promise of new life

A sermon without the gospel is not Christian preaching.

3. Preaching Must Confront Error

Doctrine protects the church from deception.

The preacher must:

- expose false teaching

One God in Jesus Christ

- correct misunderstanding
- guard the flock
- uphold truth

Silence in the face of error is unfaithfulness.

V. Preaching That Forms the Church

1. Preaching Shapes the Identity of the Church

What is preached consistently becomes what the church believes.

If preaching is:

- shallow → the church becomes shallow
- emotional → the church becomes unstable
- doctrinal → the church becomes strong

Preaching forms the church's worldview.

2. Preaching Produces Spiritual Maturity

Preaching must:

- feed the believer
- challenge the complacent
- strengthen the weak
- equip the saints

Maturity is not produced by inspiration alone — it is produced by truth.

3. Preaching Drives Mission

A church that hears truth will proclaim truth.

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Preaching fuels:

- evangelism
- discipleship
- holiness
- service

The preached Word sends the church into the world.

VI. The Preacher's Responsibility

1. To Study Diligently

A preacher must labor in the Word.

Study is not optional — it is obedience.

2. To Pray Continually

Preaching without prayer is powerless.

Prayer gives:

- clarity
- boldness
- discernment
- anointing

3. To Live Worthy of the Message

The preacher must embody what he proclaims.

His life must not contradict his sermon.

4. To Preach the Whole Counsel of God

One God in Jesus Christ

Not just:

- popular topics
- comfortable truths
- familiar passages

But the full revelation of Scripture.

Preaching declares truth; discipleship forms lives according to that truth.

VII. Conclusion: Doctrine Gives Preaching Its Power

Preaching is the church's proclamation of divine truth. Doctrine is the foundation of that proclamation.

When preaching is doctrinal:

- the church is strengthened
- the sinner is confronted
- the gospel is exalted
- Christ is glorified

Preaching that is rooted in truth becomes the voice of God to His people.

VIII. Summary

1. Preaching is the public proclamation of divine truth; doctrine gives preaching its message and preaching gives doctrine its voice (2 Timothy 4:2).

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2. Apostolic preaching is rooted in Scripture, not personality, and must be clear enough to convict, instruct, and strengthen.
 3. True authority comes from God through alignment with His Word, and it requires conviction formed by prayer, study, and obedience.
 4. The preacher's life must match the message; holiness and integrity protect the credibility and power of preaching.
 5. Preaching must be doctrinal: presenting the gospel clearly, confronting error, and guarding the flock from deception.
 6. Doctrinal preaching forms the church—shaping identity, producing maturity, and driving mission.
-

IX. Study Questions

1. Why is preaching defined as proclamation rather than commentary, and how does 2 Timothy 4:2 support that?
 2. What does it look like for preaching to be rooted in Scripture rather than in personality or style?
 3. How do prayer and study shape conviction and authority in the preacher?
 4. Why must preaching present the gospel clearly, and what happens to the church when preaching becomes moral advice only?
 5. How does consistent doctrinal preaching shape the identity and mission of a local church?
-

X. Ministry / Application

1. **For preachers:** Build sermons around a primary passage, then preach the text's meaning and call for the text's obedience.

2. For ministry teams: Establish shared doctrinal language so messages “speak the same thing” and reinforce unity.

3. For leaders: Protect the pulpit—prioritize prayerful, studied, holy preachers rather than gifted personalities alone.

4. For discipleship: Help new believers evaluate sermons by Scripture: What did the text say, what did it mean, and what must I obey?

XI. Memory Verse

1. 2 Timothy 4:2 — “Preach the word; be instant in season, out of season; reprove, rebuke, exhort with all longsuffering and doctrine.”

Chapter 12 — Doctrine and Discipleship

Teaching as Formation • Doctrine and Maturity •
Discipleship as Obedience • Building a
Teaching Culture

Chapter 12 — Doctrine and Discipleship

Teaching as Formation • Doctrine and Maturity • Discipleship as Obedience • Building a Teaching Culture

I. Introduction: Discipleship Is the Formation of a Life

Discipleship is not a program, a class, or a curriculum. Discipleship is the **formation of a believer's life** according to the truth of God.

Doctrine shapes discipleship because doctrine defines:

- who God is
- who we are
- what obedience requires
- what holiness looks like

Discipleship is the process of bringing a believer's life into alignment with revealed truth.

II. Teaching as Formation

1. Teaching Shapes Identity

Teaching is not merely the transfer of information. Teaching forms:

- convictions
- habits
- worldview
- character

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Jesus did not say, “Teach them information.” He said:

- “Teach them to observe all things whatsoever I have commanded you.” (Matthew 28:20)

Teaching forms obedience.

2. Teaching Shapes the Mind

Discipleship begins with the renewal of the mind.

- “Be transformed by the renewing of your mind.” (Romans 12:2)

A renewed mind:

- discerns truth
- rejects error
- embraces holiness
- resists the world

Teaching is the instrument God uses to reshape the believer’s thinking.

3. Teaching Shapes the Heart

Doctrine is not cold. Doctrine warms the heart toward God.

Teaching produces:

- love for truth
- reverence for God
- desire for holiness
- hunger for righteousness

Formation is both intellectual and spiritual.

III. Doctrine and Maturity

1. Maturity Requires Truth

A believer cannot grow without doctrine.

- “Desire the sincere milk of the word, that ye may grow thereby.” (1 Peter 2:2)

Doctrine is the food of spiritual growth.

2. Immaturity Is the Result of Shallow Teaching

Paul warned of believers who remain children:

- tossed by every wind of doctrine
- unstable
- easily deceived

Shallow teaching produces shallow disciples.

3. Doctrine Produces Stability

Mature believers:

- stand firm
- discern error
- endure trials
- walk in holiness

Doctrine anchors the soul.

4. Doctrine Produces Christlikeness

The goal of discipleship is not knowledge — it is transformation.

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- “Till we all come... unto a perfect man, unto the measure of the stature of the fulness of Christ.” (Ephesians 4:13)

Doctrine shapes the believer into the image of Christ.

IV. Discipleship as Obedience

1. Discipleship Is Following Jesus

A disciple is not someone who knows about Jesus — a disciple is someone who **follows** Jesus.

Following requires:

- surrender
- obedience
- sacrifice
- faithfulness

2. Obedience Is the Evidence of Discipleship

Jesus said:

- “If ye continue in My word, then are ye My disciples indeed.” (John 8:31)

Discipleship is not measured by:

- attendance
- enthusiasm
- emotion

It is measured by obedience.

3. Obedience Requires Teaching

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People cannot obey what they do not understand.

Teaching clarifies:

- God's commands
- God's expectations
- God's standards
- God's promises

Obedience flows from understanding.

4. Discipleship Requires Accountability

A disciple grows through:

- correction
- encouragement
- guidance
- community

Accountability is not control — it is care.

V. Building a Teaching Culture

1. The Church Must Be a Teaching Community

The early church was built on:

- the apostles' doctrine
- fellowship
- breaking of bread
- prayers

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(Acts 2:42)

Doctrine was not an activity — it was the culture.

2. Teaching Must Be Consistent

A teaching culture requires:

- regular instruction
- clear doctrine
- faithful teachers
- intentional formation

Consistency produces depth.

3. Teaching Must Be Accessible

Doctrine must be taught in ways that:

- the new believer can grasp
- the mature believer can grow
- the entire church can apply

Accessibility is not simplification — it is clarity.

4. Teaching Must Be Multigenerational

A teaching culture passes truth to:

- children
- youth
- adults
- families

Doctrine must be preserved and transmitted.

5. Teaching Must Be Lived

A teaching culture is not built by classrooms alone. It is built by lives that embody the truth.

Doctrine becomes culture when doctrine becomes lifestyle.

Discipleship forms believers; leadership forms the environment where discipleship thrives.

VI. Conclusion: Doctrine Forms Disciples

Discipleship is the formation of believers into the likeness of Christ. Doctrine is the foundation of that formation.

When discipleship is doctrinal:

- believers grow
- the church matures
- obedience increases
- holiness deepens
- Christ is revealed

Discipleship that is rooted in truth produces a church that reflects the character of its Lord.

VII. Summary

1. Discipleship is the formation of a believer's life according to revealed truth, not merely participation in a program.

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2. Teaching forms identity, mind, and heart, shaping convictions, habits, worldview, and obedience (Matthew 28:20).
 3. Maturity requires doctrine; shallow teaching produces instability, while sound teaching produces discernment and endurance (1 Peter 2:2).
 4. Doctrine produces Christlikeness, aiming at transformation rather than information (Ephesians 4:13).
 5. Discipleship is measured by obedience and requires clear teaching, understanding, and accountability (John 8:31).
 6. A teaching culture is built through consistency, clarity, accessibility, multigenerational transmission, and lives that embody truth (Acts 2:42).
-

VIII. Study Questions

1. Why does discipleship require doctrine, and what happens to believers when teaching is shallow?
 2. How does teaching shape identity, mind, and heart, and why must discipleship address all three?
 3. What does it mean to “teach them to observe” (Matthew 28:20), and how is that different from teaching information only?
 4. Why is accountability necessary for discipleship, and what forms can healthy accountability take in the church?
 5. What practical steps can a local church take to build a consistent, multigenerational teaching culture?
-

IX. Ministry / Application

One God in Jesus Christ

1. For teachers: Teach toward obedience—end each lesson with specific, scriptural “next steps” that learners can practice immediately.

2. For leaders: Build a discipleship pathway anchored in doctrine (new birth, holiness, worship, mission), with clear milestones for growth.

3. For mentors: Use Scripture in every conversation—ask disciples to read, explain, and apply one passage weekly, then follow up on obedience.

4. For the church: Create a teaching culture by repeating core doctrines regularly and training faithful people to teach others (2 Timothy 2:2).

X. Memory Verse

1. 2 Timothy 2:2 — “And the things that thou hast heard of me among many witnesses, the same commit thou to faithful men, who shall be able to teach others also.”

Chapter 13 — Doctrine and Leadership

Leaders as Guardians of Doctrine • Integrity and Accountability • Leading Without Compromise • Building Doctrinally Faithful Teams

Chapter 13 — Doctrine and Leadership

Leaders as Guardians of Doctrine • Integrity and Accountability • Leading Without Compromise • Building Doctrinally Faithful Teams

I. Introduction: Leadership Is Stewardship of Truth

Christian leadership is not primarily administrative, organizational, or positional. Leadership in the church is **stewardship of the truth of God**.

Doctrine shapes leadership because doctrine defines:

- the message leaders protect
- the character leaders embody
- the mission leaders advance
- the culture leaders create

A leader who does not guard doctrine cannot lead the church of Jesus Christ.

II. Leaders as Guardians of Doctrine

1. Leaders Protect the Revelation of God

Paul commanded Timothy:

- “Hold fast the form of sound words.” (2 Timothy 1:13)

Leaders are entrusted with:

- preserving truth

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- defending truth
- transmitting truth
- embodying truth

Doctrine is not optional for leaders — it is their primary responsibility.

2. Leaders Guard the Church From Error

False doctrine is not merely incorrect — it is destructive.

Leaders must:

- confront false teaching
- correct confusion
- silence deception
- protect the flock

A leader who refuses to guard doctrine abandons the church to danger.

3. Leaders Teach With Authority

Guarding doctrine includes teaching doctrine.

Leaders must:

- know the Word
- handle it faithfully
- teach it clearly
- apply it wisely

A leader cannot guard what he cannot explain.

III. Integrity and Accountability

1. Leadership Requires Integrity

A leader's life must match the truth he proclaims.

Integrity includes:

- purity
- honesty
- humility
- consistency

A leader without integrity cannot lead with authority.

2. Leadership Requires Transparency

Accountability is not weakness — it is protection.

Leaders must be accountable:

- to God
- to Scripture
- to fellow leaders
- to the church

Accountability guards the leader's soul and strengthens the leader's influence.

3. Leadership Requires Faithfulness

A leader must be faithful in:

- doctrine
- character

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- relationships
- responsibilities

Faithfulness is the measure of leadership in Scripture.

IV. Leading Without Compromise

1. Leaders Must Stand Firm in Truth

Leadership requires courage.

Leaders must stand firm when:

- truth is unpopular
- culture is hostile
- pressure is intense
- compromise is convenient

A compromising leader cannot produce a faithful church.

2. Leaders Must Resist the Temptation of Popularity

Leadership is not about:

- pleasing people
- gaining approval
- avoiding conflict

Leadership is about obedience to God.

A leader who seeks popularity will eventually sacrifice truth.

3. Leaders Must Confront Sin and Error

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Love does not avoid confrontation — love confronts for the sake of restoration.

Leaders must:

- correct with humility
- rebuke with clarity
- restore with compassion

Compromise destroys. Correction heals.

V. Building Doctrinally Faithful Teams

1. Leaders Multiply Themselves Through Teaching

A doctrinally faithful leader raises doctrinally faithful leaders.

Paul told Timothy:

- “Commit thou to faithful men, who shall be able to teach others also.” (2 Timothy 2:2)

Leadership development is doctrinal multiplication.

2. Leaders Build Teams That Share Conviction

A team must be united in:

- doctrine
- mission
- values
- holiness

Unity in doctrine produces unity in purpose.

3. Leaders Model What They Expect

A doctrinal culture is not built by instruction alone — it is built by example.

Leaders must model:

- prayer
- study
- holiness
- humility
- faithfulness

Doctrine becomes culture when leaders embody truth.

4. Leaders Create Environments Where Truth Shapes Practice

A doctrinally faithful team:

- makes decisions based on Scripture
- evaluates ministry through truth
- measures success by obedience
- prioritizes spiritual formation

Doctrine becomes the operating system of leadership.

Worship, preaching, discipleship, and leadership are not separate ministries — they are unified expressions of doctrine lived out in the church. When doctrine shapes every dimension of ministry, the church becomes strong, stable, and apostolic.

VI. Conclusion: Leadership Anchored in Truth

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Leadership in the church is not defined by charisma, skill, or influence. Leadership is defined by **faithfulness to the truth of God**.

When leadership is doctrinal:

- the church is protected
- the mission is preserved
- the saints are strengthened
- Christ is honored

Leaders who guard doctrine build churches that endure.

VII. Summary

1. Leadership in the church is stewardship of truth; leaders are responsible to preserve, defend, transmit, and embody apostolic doctrine (2 Timothy 1:13).
2. Leaders guard the church from error through doctrinal clarity, correction, and faithful teaching, refusing silence in the face of deception.
3. Integrity is essential to leadership; credibility and authority collapse when character contradicts doctrine (Titus 1:7).
4. Accountability protects leaders and strengthens influence by promoting humility, transparency, and faithfulness.
5. Doctrinal leadership refuses compromise stands firm when truth is unpopular and confronts sin and error with restoration in view.

One God in Jesus Christ

6. Doctrinally faithful teams are built through multiplication, shared conviction, modeling, and ministry environments where Scripture governs practice (2 Timothy 2:2).

VIII. Study Questions

1. Why is leadership defined as stewardship of truth, and what happens when leaders treat doctrine as secondary?
 2. What practical responsibilities do leaders have in guarding the church from false doctrine?
 3. How do integrity and accountability protect a leader's authority and the church's spiritual health?
 4. What is the difference between biblical firmness and sinful harshness when confronting error and sin?
 5. How can leaders build teams that share conviction and transmit doctrine faithfully to the next generation?
-

IX. Ministry / Application

1. For leaders: Identify the non-negotiable doctrines your church must preserve and ensure they are taught repeatedly with clarity.

2. For ministry teams: Build shared doctrinal language—agree on key definitions and Scriptures so the team “speaks the same thing.”

3. For accountability: Establish spiritual oversight that encourages transparency and correction before compromise becomes collapse.

4. For leadership development: Train faithful people to teach others by pairing doctrine instruction with character formation and supervised ministry (2 Timothy 2:2).

X. Memory Verse

One God in Jesus Christ

1. 2 Timothy 1:13 — “Hold fast the form of sound words, which thou hast heard of me, in faith and love which is in Christ Jesus.”

SECTION IV

TEACHING MODULES FOR CHURCH USE

This section provides ready-to-teach modules designed for discipleship classes, small groups, new believers, and church-wide instruction. Each module distills essential doctrines into clear, teachable lessons that can be used in any ministry setting. These modules ensure that the church teaches with consistency, clarity, and biblical fidelity. They are practical tools for forming believers, strengthening foundations, and building a culture of doctrinal teaching across generations.

Module 1 — The Bible: God's Word

Inspiration • Authority • Reliability • Obedience

Module 1 — The Bible: God’s Word

Inspiration • Authority • Reliability • Obedience

I. Lesson Overview

This module introduces the Bible as the inspired, authoritative, and sufficient Word of God. It establishes Scripture as the foundation for all doctrine, experience, and Christian living. The goal is to help learners understand what the Bible is, why it can be trusted, and how it functions as God’s revelation to humanity. By the end of this lesson, students should recognize the Bible as the final authority for faith and practice and develop a commitment to reading, studying, and obeying it.

II. Key Scriptures

- 2 Timothy 3:16–17 — All Scripture is inspired and profitable.
- 2 Peter 1:20–21 — Holy men spoke as they were moved by the Holy Ghost.
- Psalm 119:89 — God’s Word is forever settled.
- John 17:17 — God’s Word is truth.
- Isaiah 40:8 — The Word of our God shall stand forever.
- Matthew 24:35 — Heaven and earth shall pass away, but His words shall not.

III. Core Teaching Points

1. The Bible is the inspired Word of God

God breathed His Word through human authors.

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Scripture carries divine authority, not human opinion.

Inspiration ensures accuracy, reliability, and unity.

2. The Bible is the final authority for faith and life

All doctrine must align with Scripture.

Experience is validated by the Word, not the other way around.

The Bible corrects, instructs, and equips believers.

3. The Bible reveals God's plan for humanity

Creation, fall, redemption, restoration.

The identity of Jesus Christ.

The way of salvation.

The life God calls His people to live.

4. The Bible must be read, studied, and obeyed

Understanding comes through study and meditation.

Obedience brings transformation.

The Spirit guides believers into truth.

IV. Expanded Teaching Notes

1. What the Bible Is

The Bible is not merely a religious book; it is God's revelation of Himself. It contains 66 books written over 1,500 years by more than 40 authors, yet it speaks with one unified voice because its true Author is God. Scripture reveals God's character, His will, and His plan for salvation.

2. Inspiration and Authority

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“Inspiration” means God breathed His Word into human writers. They wrote using their own vocabulary and style, but the message came from God. Because Scripture is inspired, it is authoritative. It is the final standard for doctrine, morality, and spiritual life. No tradition, opinion, or experience can override the Word.

3. The Reliability of Scripture

The Bible has been preserved through centuries with remarkable accuracy. Archaeology, history, and fulfilled prophecy confirm its reliability. More importantly, Jesus Himself affirmed the authority of Scripture. The Bible is trustworthy because God is faithful.

4. The Purpose of Scripture

The Bible teaches us who God is, who we are, and how we can be saved. It reveals Jesus Christ as the full expression of God’s nature. It instructs believers in righteousness, equips them for ministry, and forms them into the image of Christ.

5. How to Approach the Bible

Believers must read the Bible with reverence, humility, and expectation. Study should be prayerful and Spirit-guided. The goal is not only knowledge but transformation. The Word must be obeyed, not merely understood.

The Bible reveals God — and the clearest revelation of God is Jesus Christ.

V. Discussion Questions

1. What does it mean that the Bible is “inspired by God”?

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2. Why must Scripture be the final authority for doctrine and life?
3. How does the Bible reveal who Jesus is?
4. What role does the Holy Ghost play in understanding Scripture?
5. What practical steps can you take to deepen your study of the Word?

VI. Application / Life Response

- Commit to reading the Bible daily.
- Begin a simple study plan (e.g., Gospels, Acts, Psalms, Proverbs).
- Pray before reading: “Lord, open my understanding.”
- Apply one truth from Scripture each day.
- Share what you learn with someone else.

VII. Memory Verse

1. 2 Timothy 3:16 — “All scripture is given by inspiration of God, and is profitable for doctrine, for reproof, for correction, for instruction in righteousness:”

Module 2 — Who Is Jesus?

Oneness • Incarnation • Saving Name •
Revelation of the Father

Module 2 — Who Is Jesus?

Oneness • Incarnation • Saving Name • Revelation of the Father

I. Lesson Overview

This module presents the identity of Jesus Christ as revealed in Scripture. It establishes that Jesus is not a second divine person but the full and complete manifestation of the one true God in flesh. Students will learn who Jesus is, why His identity matters, and how the revelation of Jesus Christ forms the foundation of the Apostolic faith. By the end of this lesson, learners should understand that Jesus is both fully God and fully man — the visible image of the invisible God and the only saving Name.

II. Key Scriptures

- Deuteronomy 6:4 — The LORD our God is one LORD.
- Isaiah 9:6 — The Son is called the Mighty God, Everlasting Father.
- John 1:1,14 — The Word was God... and the Word was made flesh.
- John 14:9 — He that hath seen Me hath seen the Father.
- Colossians 1:15 — Jesus is the image of the invisible God.
- Colossians 2:9 — In Him dwells all the fullness of the Godhead bodily.
- 1 Timothy 3:16 — God was manifest in the flesh.

III. Core Teaching Points

One God in Jesus Christ

1. Jesus is the one true God revealed in flesh

- God is one, not three.
- Jesus is the full revelation of the Father.
- The deity of Jesus is central to salvation.

2. Jesus is fully God and fully man

- As God: He forgives sins, receives worship, and has all authority.
- As man: He experienced hunger, fatigue, temptation, and suffering.
- The incarnation unites God's divinity with true humanity.

3. The Name of Jesus is the saving Name

- Salvation is in no other name (Acts 4:12).
- Baptism is performed in the name of Jesus.
- The authority of Jesus' Name is rooted in His identity.

4. Jesus reveals the Father

- Not a second person, but the Father manifested.
- The works of Jesus are the works of God.
- To know Jesus is to know God.

IV. Expanded Teaching Notes

1. The Oneness of God and the Identity of Jesus

The Bible consistently reveals one God. This one God manifested Himself in the person of Jesus Christ. Jesus is not a lesser deity or a separate divine being — He is the fullness of God in human form. The

One God in Jesus Christ

Old Testament declares God is one; the New Testament reveals that this one God came to us as Jesus.

2. The Incarnation: God in Flesh

John 1:14 states that the Word — who was God — became flesh. This means God did not send another being; He came Himself. Jesus is God expressing Himself in a human body. He lived a sinless life, experienced human limitations, and demonstrated divine authority.

3. The Dual Nature of Christ

Jesus is both fully God and fully man.

- As God, He healed the sick, forgave sins, and commanded nature.
- As man, He grew tired, slept, ate, and prayed.

These two natures are united in one person — Jesus Christ.

4. Jesus as the Revelation of the Father

When Philip asked to see the Father, Jesus replied, “He that hath seen Me hath seen the Father.” Jesus is not a representative of God — He is God revealed. Every attribute of the Father is expressed in Christ.

5. The Saving Name of Jesus

Because Jesus is God manifested in flesh, His Name carries divine authority. Baptism in Jesus’ Name is not a formula — it is an act of faith in the identity of the One who saves. The apostles consistently baptized in the Name of Jesus because they understood who He is.

Knowing who Jesus is forms the foundation for understanding salvation, the gospel, and the life of the believer.

V. Discussion Questions

1. Why is it essential to understand that God is one?

One God in Jesus Christ

2. How does the incarnation reveal God's love for humanity?
3. What does it mean that Jesus is both fully God and fully man?
4. Why did the apostles baptize in the name of Jesus?
5. How does knowing who Jesus is affect your daily walk with God?

VI. Application / Life Response

- Worship Jesus with full understanding of His identity.
- Pray in the Name of Jesus with confidence in His authority.
- Share the revelation of who Jesus is with someone this week.
- Reflect on how the incarnation shows God's love for you personally.
- Commit to studying the Gospels to know Jesus more deeply.

VII. Memory Verse

1. Colossians 2:9 — “For in him dwelleth all the fulness of the Godhead bodily.”

Module 3 — Salvation According to Scripture

Repentance • Baptism in Jesus' Name • Holy
Ghost • New Life

Module 3 — Salvation According to Scripture

*Repentance • Baptism in Jesus' Name • Holy Ghost
• New Life*

I. Lesson Overview

This module explains the biblical plan of salvation as taught and practiced by Jesus and the apostles. It emphasizes that salvation is not based on tradition, personal interpretation, or denominational teaching, but on the clear pattern revealed in Scripture. Students will learn the essential components of salvation — faith, repentance, water baptism in Jesus' Name, and the infilling of the Holy Ghost — and understand how these elements form the new birth experience Jesus described. By the end of this lesson, learners should be able to articulate the apostolic message of salvation and apply it personally.

II. Key Scriptures

- John 3:5 — Born of water and Spirit.
- Mark 1:15 — Repent and believe the gospel.
- Acts 2:38 — Repent, be baptized in Jesus' Name, receive the Holy Ghost.
- Acts 10:44–48 — Gentiles receive the Spirit and are baptized.
- Acts 19:1–6 — Disciples rebaptized in Jesus' Name and filled with the Spirit.
- Romans 6:4 — Buried with Christ in baptism.
- Titus 3:5 — The washing of regeneration and renewing of the Holy Ghost.

III. Core Teaching Points

1. Salvation begins with faith in Jesus Christ

- Faith is the foundation of the gospel response.
- True faith leads to obedience, not mere belief.
- The gospel is the power of God unto salvation.

2. Repentance is the first step of obedience

- Turning away from sin and turning toward God.
- Produces godly sorrow and a changed direction.
- Repentance prepares the heart for new birth.

3. Water baptism in the name of Jesus Christ is essential

- Baptism is for the remission of sins.
- The apostles always baptized in Jesus' Name.
- Baptism identifies us with the death and burial of Christ.

4. The infilling of the Holy Ghost completes the new birth

- The Spirit gives power, transformation, and identity.
- The book of Acts shows consistent evidence of Spirit baptism.
- The Spirit leads believers into truth and holiness.

5. Salvation is a new life, not just an event

- Walking in the Spirit.
- Growing in holiness.
- Living as a disciple of Jesus.

IV. Expanded Teaching Notes

1. The Gospel: Death, Burial, Resurrection

One God in Jesus Christ

Paul defines the gospel in 1 Corinthians 15:1–4.

- Repentance corresponds to Christ's death — dying to sin.
- Baptism corresponds to burial — our old life is buried with Him.
- Spirit infilling corresponds to resurrection — rising to new life.

The new birth is not symbolic; it is a real spiritual transformation.

2. Repentance: A Change of Heart and Direction

Repentance is more than feeling sorry. It is a decision to turn away from sin and surrender to God. It prepares the heart for baptism and Spirit infilling. Without repentance, baptism becomes empty ritual.

3. Baptism in Jesus' Name: The Apostolic Pattern

Every recorded baptism in the New Testament was performed in the name of Jesus Christ.

- Acts 2:38 — Jews
- Acts 8:16 — Samaritans
- Acts 10:48 — Gentiles
- Acts 19:5 — Disciples of John

Baptism is not optional; it is commanded. It washes away sins, unites us with Christ, and places His Name upon our lives.

4. The Holy Ghost: Power and Transformation

The Holy Ghost is God's Spirit living inside the believer.

- Gives power to overcome sin.
- Produces spiritual fruit.
- Brings revelation and guidance.

One God in Jesus Christ

- Is accompanied by supernatural evidence in Acts.

The Spirit is not an emotional experience — it is the life of God entering the believer.

The new birth produces a new life — and that new life is expressed through holiness.

5. Salvation as a Lifelong Walk

Salvation is both an event and a process.

- We are saved by obeying the gospel.
- We are being saved as we walk with God.
- We will be saved when Christ returns.

The new birth begins a new life of holiness, discipleship, and spiritual growth.

V. Discussion Questions

1. Why is faith essential to salvation?
2. What is the difference between repentance and regret?
3. Why did the apostles baptize in the name of Jesus?
4. What does the Holy Ghost do in the life of a believer?
5. How does salvation continue after the new birth?

VI. Application / Life Response

- Examine your heart: Have you truly repented?
- If not yet baptized in Jesus' Name, make it a priority.
- Seek the infilling of the Holy Ghost with expectation.
- Commit to walking daily in the Spirit.

One God in Jesus Christ

- Share your salvation testimony with someone this week.
- Salvation is God's greatest gift — and our greatest responsibility is to respond fully and faithfully.

VII. Memory Verse

Acts 2:38 — Repent, and be baptized every one of you in the name of Jesus Christ...

Module 4 — Living a Holy Life

Identity • Separation • Transformation • Spirit-
Empowered Living

Module 4 — Living a Holy Life

Identity • Separation • Transformation • Spirit-Empowered Living

I. Lesson Overview

This module teaches the biblical call to holiness as the lifestyle of every believer. Holiness is not an optional standard for a select few — it is the identity and expectation of all who have been born again. Students will learn that holiness is both positional (what God declares us to be) and practical (how we live daily). The lesson emphasizes that holiness flows from relationship with God, empowered by the Spirit, and expressed in attitudes, conduct, and appearance. By the end of this module, learners should understand that holiness is not legalism, but the natural result of a transformed life.

II. Key Scriptures

- Leviticus 20:7 — Be holy, for I am the LORD your God.
- 1 Peter 1:15–16 — Be holy in all manner of conversation.
- Hebrews 12:14 — Without holiness no one will see the Lord.
- Romans 12:1–2 — Present your bodies... be transformed.
- 2 Corinthians 6:17–18 — Come out from among them.
- Galatians 5:16–25 — Walk in the Spirit.
- Titus 2:11–12 — Grace teaches us to deny ungodliness.

III. Core Teaching Points

1. Holiness is God's command, not a suggestion

One God in Jesus Christ

God calls His people to be distinct.

Holiness reflects God's nature.

It is required for fellowship with Him.

2. Holiness begins in the heart

Transformation starts internally.

Attitudes, desires, and motives matter.

The Spirit produces inward holiness.

3. Holiness is expressed outwardly

Conduct, speech, and lifestyle reflect the heart.

Modesty, integrity, and purity are visible expressions.

Outward holiness is not legalism — it is obedience.

4. Holiness is empowered by the Holy Ghost

The Spirit gives power to overcome sin.

Holiness is not achieved by human effort alone.

Grace teaches and strengthens us to live godly.

5. Holiness separates believers from the world

Not isolation, but distinction.

We reject sinful values and practices.

We live as witnesses of Christ's character.

IV. Expanded Teaching Notes

1. The Call to Holiness

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Holiness is rooted in God's own character. Because God is holy, His people must reflect His nature. Holiness is not about rules — it is about relationship. When God saves us, He sets us apart for Himself. This separation is both a privilege and a responsibility.

2. Inward Holiness: The Heart of the Matter

Jesus taught that sin begins in the heart. Holiness therefore starts with inner transformation.

- Pure thoughts
- Godly desires
- Christlike attitudes
- A humble and obedient spirit

The fruit of the Spirit (Galatians 5) is the evidence of inward holiness.

3. Outward Holiness: The Visible Witness

Outward holiness is the natural expression of inward transformation. The Bible teaches modesty, purity, honesty, and self-control. Our appearance, speech, and behavior should reflect our identity as God's people. Outward holiness is not about earning salvation — it is about honoring God with our bodies and lifestyle.

4. The Role of the Holy Ghost

Holiness is impossible without the Spirit. The Holy Ghost gives power to resist temptation, strength to live differently, and conviction to avoid sin. Grace does not excuse ungodliness — it teaches us to deny it (Titus 2:11–12).

5. Separation from the World

Biblical separation is not isolation or superiority. It is choosing God's ways over the world's values. We avoid sinful influences, reject

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ungodly entertainment, and refuse practices that compromise our witness. Holiness is not about being strange — it is about being Christlike.

6. Holiness as a Lifelong Journey

Holiness is both immediate and progressive.

- God declares us holy at salvation.
- We grow in holiness as we walk with Him.
- The Spirit continually shapes us into Christ's image.

Holiness is not perfection — it is direction.

Holiness forms the believer; mission forms the believer's purpose.

V. Discussion Questions

1. Why does God call His people to be holy?
2. How does inward holiness affect outward holiness?
3. What is the difference between holiness and legalism?
4. How does the Holy Ghost empower a holy life?
5. What areas of your life is God calling you to surrender or change?

VI. Application / Life Response

Examine your heart for attitudes or habits that hinder holiness.

Ask the Holy Ghost to strengthen your desire to live godly.

Make practical changes in lifestyle, entertainment, speech, or relationships.

Commit to daily prayer and Scripture reading for spiritual growth.

Choose one area this week to intentionally practice holiness.

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Holiness is not a burden — it is the beauty of belonging to God.

VII. Memory Verse

1 Peter 1:16 — Be ye holy; for I am holy.

Module 5 — The Church and Its Mission

Identity • Mission • Spirit Empowerment • Every
Believer's Role

Module 5 — The Church and Its Mission

Identity • Mission • Spirit Empowerment • Every Believer's Role

I. Lesson Overview

This module explains what the Church is, why it exists, and what God has commissioned it to do. The Church is not a building, a denomination, or a weekly event — it is the redeemed people of God, called out of the world and sent back into it with purpose. Students will learn the biblical identity of the Church, the mission Jesus gave to His followers, and the responsibilities of every believer within the body. By the end of this lesson, learners should understand that the Church is God's instrument for advancing His kingdom and that every disciple has a role in that mission.

II. Key Scriptures

- Matthew 16:18 — Jesus builds His Church.
- Acts 2:42–47 — The life and practices of the early Church.
- Matthew 28:19–20 — The Great Commission.
- Mark 16:15–18 — Preach the gospel to every creature.
- Acts 1:8 — Power to be witnesses.
- Ephesians 4:11–16 — The Church equipped for ministry.
- 1 Peter 2:9 — A chosen generation, a royal priesthood.

III. Core Teaching Points

1. The Church is the people of God

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- Called out of darkness into His marvelous light.
- A spiritual body, not a physical institution.
- United by the Spirit, the Name, and the gospel.

2. The Church exists to continue the mission of Jesus

- Preach the gospel.
- Make disciples.
- Demonstrate the kingdom through love, holiness, and power.

3. The Church is empowered by the Holy Ghost

- The Spirit gives boldness to witness.
- Spiritual gifts equip the body for ministry.
- The Church operates in supernatural authority.

4. The Church is a community of disciples

- Fellowship, prayer, teaching, and breaking of bread.
- Mutual encouragement and accountability.
- Growth through unity and service.

5. Every believer has a role in the mission

- Ministry is not limited to pastors or leaders.
- Each member contributes to the body's health.
- The mission advances when every disciple is active.

IV. Expanded Teaching Notes

1. What the Church Is

The word “church” (ekklesia) means “called-out ones.” The Church is the community of people who have been redeemed by Jesus and filled

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with His Spirit. It is not defined by architecture, tradition, or culture — it is defined by identity and purpose. Jesus is the head of the Church, and believers are members of His body.

2. The Mission of Jesus Continued

Jesus came to seek and save the lost, proclaim the kingdom, heal the broken, and destroy the works of the devil. Before ascending, He entrusted this mission to His followers. The Great Commission is not a suggestion — it is the mandate of the Church. Evangelism, discipleship, and teaching are central to the Church's identity.

3. Empowered for Purpose

Acts 1:8 reveals that the Holy Ghost is given for power — specifically, power to be witnesses. The early Church did not rely on human ability but on the supernatural empowerment of the Spirit. Spiritual gifts (1 Corinthians 12) are given to build up the body and advance the mission.

4. The Church as a Community

Acts 2:42–47 describes a Church devoted to teaching, fellowship, prayer, generosity, and unity. This community life strengthened believers and attracted others. The Church grows when it is healthy, loving, and spiritually vibrant.

5. The Role of Every Believer

The Church is not a spectator gathering. Every believer is called, gifted, and needed.

- Some teach.
- Some serve.
- Some encourage.
- Some lead.

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- All witness.

The mission of the Church advances when every disciple embraces their calling.

6. The Church as God's Witness in the World

The Church represents Jesus to the world. Through holiness, compassion, truth, and spiritual authority, the Church reveals God's character. The world sees Jesus through His people.

The mission of the Church is urgent because eternity is certain.

V. Discussion Questions

1. What does it mean that the Church is the "called-out" people of God?
2. Why is the Great Commission central to the Church's identity?
3. How does the Holy Ghost empower the Church's mission?
4. What practices from Acts 2 should shape the Church today?
5. What role do you believe God is calling you to fulfill in the body?

VI. Application / Life Response

- Commit to being an active participant in the mission, not a passive observer.
- Pray for boldness to share the gospel with someone this week.
- Identify your spiritual gifts and begin using them in the Church.
- Strengthen your connection to the body through fellowship and service.
- Ask God to give you a burden for souls and for the mission of the Church.

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The Church is God's chosen instrument — and you are part of that calling.

VII. Memory Verse

Acts 1:8 — But ye shall receive power, after that the Holy Ghost is come upon you: and ye shall be witnesses...

Module 6 — Preparing for Eternity

Return of Christ • Resurrection • Judgment •
Readiness

Module 6 — Preparing for Eternity

Return of Christ • Resurrection • Judgment • Readiness

I. Lesson Overview

This module teaches the biblical reality of eternity and the believer's responsibility to live with eternal perspective. Scripture reveals that every person will spend eternity either with God or separated from Him. Students will learn about the return of Jesus Christ, the resurrection, the final judgment, and the hope of eternal life. The lesson emphasizes readiness, holiness, and faithful stewardship as essential responses to the certainty of eternity. By the end of this module, learners should understand that eternity is not abstract theology — it is the ultimate destination that shapes how we live today.

II. Key Scriptures

- John 14:1–3 — Jesus prepares a place for us.
- 1 Thessalonians 4:16–17 — The catching away of the Church.
- Hebrews 9:27 — It is appointed unto men once to die.
- Revelation 20:11–15 — The final judgment.
- Matthew 25:1–13 — The parable of the wise and foolish virgins.
- 2 Corinthians 5:10 — We must all appear before the judgment seat of Christ.
- Titus 2:13 — Looking for the blessed hope.

1. Eternity is certain for every person

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- Life is temporary; eternity is permanent.
- Death is not the end — it is the beginning of forever.
- Scripture reveals two eternal destinies.

2. Jesus Christ will return for His Church

- His return is promised and certain.
- The Church will be caught up to meet Him.
- Believers must live in readiness.

3. There will be a final judgment

- All will stand before God.
- The righteous will enter eternal life.
- The unrighteous will face eternal separation.

4. Eternal life is the hope of the believer

- A new heaven and new earth.
- No more pain, sorrow, or death.
- Eternal fellowship with Jesus.

5. Preparing for eternity requires daily faithfulness

- Holiness, obedience, and perseverance.
- Stewardship of time, gifts, and opportunities.
- Living with urgency and purpose.

1. The Reality of Eternity

The Bible teaches that earthly life is brief compared to eternity. Every decision, every action, and every response to God carries eternal

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weight. Eternity is not symbolic — it is the ultimate reality. Understanding this truth brings clarity to life's priorities.

2. The Return of Jesus Christ

Jesus promised to return for His people. The early Church lived with expectation, urgency, and hope. The return of Christ is not meant to create fear but to inspire readiness. Believers are called to watch, pray, and remain faithful.

3. The Resurrection and Judgment

Scripture teaches a resurrection of both the righteous and the unrighteous.

- The righteous will rise to eternal life.
- The unrighteous will rise to judgment.

The judgment seat of Christ evaluates the works of believers, while the Great White Throne judgment determines the eternal destiny of the lost. God's judgment is righteous, perfect, and final.

4. The Hope of Eternal Life

For the believer, eternity is not dread — it is hope. Heaven is the fulfillment of God's promise:

- A place prepared by Jesus.
- A world without sin, suffering, or death.
- Eternal joy in the presence of God.

This hope strengthens believers in trials and motivates perseverance.

5. Living in Readiness

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Jesus taught that His return will be sudden. The parable of the ten virgins emphasizes preparedness. Readiness is not fear-driven — it is relationship-driven. Believers prepare by:

- Walking in holiness.
- Staying filled with the Spirit.
- Remaining faithful in prayer, service, and obedience.
- Keeping their hearts free from worldliness.

6. Stewardship in Light of Eternity

Eternity shapes how we use our time, resources, and abilities. Faithful stewardship is not optional — it is eternal investment. What we do for Christ will last forever.

The Word reveals God, Jesus reveals the Father, salvation transforms, holiness shapes, the Church advances the mission, and eternity anchors our hope. Together, these modules form the foundation of apostolic discipleship.

V. Discussion Questions

1. How does understanding eternity change the way we live today?
2. Why is the return of Jesus a source of hope for believers?
3. What does it mean to be spiritually prepared for Christ's coming?
4. How does the Bible describe the final judgment?
5. What areas of your life need realignment with eternal priorities?

VI. Application / Life Response

Examine your life in light of eternity — what needs to change?

Renew your commitment to holiness and spiritual readiness.

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Strengthen your prayer life and devotion to the Word.

Use your gifts and opportunities for God's kingdom.

Share the hope of eternal life with someone this week.

Eternity is certain — preparation is essential.

VII. Memory Verse

Titus 2:13 — Looking for that blessed hope, and the glorious appearing of the great God and our Saviour Jesus Christ.

SECTION V

WORKER GUIDELINES & MINISTRY PRACTICE

This section equips workers, teachers, and ministry leaders with the character, discipline, and spiritual posture required for effective service. It addresses the inner life of the worker, the responsible handling of Scripture, the clarity and authority of teaching, and the sacred duty of guarding the flock. These chapters form the ethical and spiritual framework for Apostolic ministry, ensuring that those who serve do so with integrity, humility, and doctrinal faithfulness.

Chapter 14 — The Worker's Life

Prayer • Study • Integrity • Submission

Chapter 14 — The Worker's Life

Prayer • Study • Integrity • Submission

I. Introduction: The Worker's Life Is the Foundation of Ministry

It begins in the hidden places where character is formed, convictions are shaped, and the Spirit of God molds the inner life.

The worker's life is the true foundation of all ministries.

If the foundation is weak, the work will not endure.

If the foundation is strong, the worker becomes a vessel God can trust.

II. Prayer

1. Prayer as the Worker's Lifeline

Prayer is the worker's lifeline. Without prayer, the worker becomes spiritually dry, directionless, and vulnerable.

2. Prayer Forms the Worker Before the Work

Prayer forms the worker before the work forms the ministry. Jesus prayed before choosing the Twelve (Luke 6:12). Paul received revelation through prayer (Ephesians 1:17–18). Prayer shapes the worker's heart before God uses their hands.

3. Prayer Produces Spiritual Authority

Prayer produces spiritual authority. Authority does not come from position but from communion with God. The apostles declared, "We

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will give ourselves continually to prayer, and to the ministry of the word” (Acts 6:4).

4. Prayer Keeps the Worker Watchful

Prayer keeps the worker watchful. Jesus commanded, “Watch and pray, that ye enter not into temptation” (Matthew 26:41). Prayer keeps the worker alert, sober, and spiritually sensitive.

III. Study

1. A Worker Must Be Shaped by the Word

A worker who handles the Word must be shaped by the Word.

2. Study Guards the Worker From Error

Study guards the worker from error. “Study to shew thyself approved unto God... rightly dividing the word of truth” (2 Timothy 2:15). Study protects the worker from drifting into error.

3. Study Equips the Worker to Teach Faithfully

Study equips the worker to teach faithfully. Ezra “prepared his heart to seek the law of the LORD, and to do it, and to teach” (Ezra 7:10). The worker cannot teach what they have not first learned.

4. Study Forms Conviction

Study forms conviction. The Bereans searched the Scriptures daily (Acts 17:11). Conviction grows when Scripture becomes the worker’s daily bread.

IV. Integrity

1. Integrity Is the Strength That Sustains Ministry

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Integrity is the invisible strength of the worker's life. Without it, ministry collapses.

2. Integrity Is Consistency Between Belief and Behavior

Integrity is consistency between belief and behavior. Leaders must be "blameless" (Titus 1:7). The worker must live what they teach.

3. Integrity Protects the Worker From Disqualification

Integrity protects the worker from disqualification. Paul warned, "Lest... when I have preached to others, I myself should be a castaway" (1 Corinthians 9:27).

4. Integrity Honors the Name of Jesus

Integrity honors the name of Jesus. "Let your light so shine... that they may see your good works and glorify your Father" (Matthew 5:16).

V. Submission

1. Submission Aligns the Worker With God's Order

Submission is not weakness; it is alignment with God's order.

2. Submission Aligns the Worker With God's Structure

Submission aligns the worker with God's structure. "Obey them that have the rule over you... for they watch for your souls" (Hebrews 13:17).

3. Submission Protects the Worker From Pride

Submission protects the worker from pride. "Be subject one to another and be clothed with humility" (1 Peter 5:5).

4. Submission Prepares the Worker for Greater Responsibility

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Submission prepares the worker for greater responsibility. “He that is faithful in that which is least is faithful also in much” (Luke 16:10).

A worker shaped by prayer, study, integrity, and submission is prepared to handle Scripture responsibly.

VI. Summary

1. A worker’s life is the foundation of ministry; strong character produces durable work and spiritual trustworthiness.
 2. Prayer sustains the worker, forms the heart, produces spiritual authority, and keeps the worker watchful against temptation.
 3. Study protects the worker from error, equips faithful teaching, and forms conviction through daily Scripture.
 4. Integrity is consistency between belief and behavior, preserving credibility and guarding the worker from disqualification.
 5. Submission aligns the worker with God’s order, protects from pride, and prepares the worker for greater responsibility.
-

VII. Study Questions

1. Why does ministry “begin in the hidden places,” and what practical habits protect a worker’s private life?
2. In what ways does prayer produce spiritual authority according to Acts 6:4, and how can a worker prioritize prayer without neglecting responsibilities?
3. What does it mean to “rightly divide the word of truth” (2 Timothy 2:15), and how can a worker guard against drifting into error?

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4. What are common threats to integrity in ministry, and what safeguards help prevent disqualification (1 Corinthians 9:27)?
 5. How does submission function as protection and preparation (Hebrews 13:17; Luke 16:10), and what does healthy submission look like in practice?
-

VIII. Ministry / Application

1. For workers: Establish a non-negotiable daily rhythm of prayer and Scripture before adding new ministry tasks.

2. For teachers: Let study lead to clarity—prepare lessons from a primary passage and verify every point with Scripture.

3. For leaders: Build accountability that protects integrity, including oversight, transparent communication, and consistent follow-through.

4. For teams: Cultivate a culture of submission and humility where counsel is welcomed and correction is received without defensiveness.

IX. Memory Verse

1. Acts 6:4 — “But we will give ourselves continually to prayer, and to the ministry of the word.”

Chapter 15 — Handling Scripture Responsibly

Context • Exegesis • Sound Doctrine • Accuracy

Chapter 15 — Handling Scripture Responsibly

Context • Exegesis • Sound Doctrine • Accuracy

I. Introduction: Why Workers Must Handle Scripture With Reverence and Accuracy

The Word of God is the foundation of apostolic doctrine, preaching, teaching, and discipleship.

Because Scripture is inspired, authoritative, and sufficient, the worker must handle it with reverence, discipline, and accuracy.

II. Contextual Reading

1. Interpret Scripture as God Intended

Scripture must be interpreted as God intended.

2. Read and Teach in Proper Setting

“Study to shew thyself approved unto God, a workman that needeth not to be ashamed, rightly dividing the word of truth.” (2 Timothy 2:15) requires understanding the passage within its proper setting.

3. Let Context Protect You From Distortion

Context protects the worker from distortion. Some “wrest the scriptures... unto their own destruction” (2 Peter 3:16).

4. Consider the Whole Counsel of God

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The whole counsel of God must be considered. “For I have not shunned to declare unto you all the counsel of God.” (Acts 20:27)

III. Exegesis vs. Eisegesis

1. Exegesis Honors God’s Voice

Exegesis honors God’s voice.

2. Let Scripture Explain Scripture

Jesus “expounded unto them in all the scriptures the things concerning himself.” (Luke 24:27)

3. Eisegesis Replaces God’s Voice With Human Opinion

Eisegesis replaces God’s voice with human opinion. “Making the word of God of none effect through your tradition” (Mark 7:13).

4. Submit to the Text

The worker must submit to the text. “Thy word is a lamp unto my feet, and a light unto my path.” (Psalm 119:105)

IV. Avoiding Doctrinal Shortcuts

1. Refuse Proof-Texting

Proof-texting is not teaching.

2. Recognize Scripture Can Be Misused

Satan quoted Scripture out of context (Matthew 4:6).

3. Labor in the Word and Doctrine

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The worker must labor in the Word. “Especially they who labour in the word and doctrine” (1 Timothy 5:17).

4. Teach Deeply to Produce Stability

Shallow teaching produces shallow disciples. The worker must teach doctrine with patience and clarity, so believers are rooted and not “carried about with every wind of doctrine” (Ephesians 4:14). Stability comes when Scripture is taught in context, repeated faithfully, and applied to obedience.

V. Teaching with Accuracy

1. Accuracy Preserves Apostolic Doctrine

Accuracy preserves apostolic doctrine. “Hold fast the form of sound words” (2 Timothy 1:13).

2. Accuracy Protects the Church

Accuracy protects the church. “By sound doctrine both to exhort and to convince” (Titus 1:9).

3. Accuracy Honors God

Accuracy honors God. “Ye shall not add unto the word... neither shall ye diminish ought from it” (Deuteronomy 4:2).

Right handling of Scripture produces clarity and authority in teaching.

VI. Summary

1. Handling Scripture responsibly begins with interpreting passages in their proper context and refusing to distort the text.

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2. Exegesis draws meaning from Scripture, while eisegesis reads personal opinion into Scripture, and the worker must submit to the text.
 3. Doctrinal shortcuts such as proof-texting produce unstable believers, so workers must labor in the Word and doctrine.
 4. Accuracy preserves apostolic doctrine, protects the church, and honors God by refusing to add to or diminish His Word.
-

VII. Study Questions

1. What common mistakes happen when Scripture is quoted without context, and how can you prevent them in teaching and preaching?
 2. Explain the difference between exegesis and eisegesis and give an example of how each approach changes interpretation.
 3. Why is proof-texting dangerous, even when the verse quoted is true?
 4. What practical steps help a worker “rightly divide the word of truth” (2 Timothy 2:15) when preparing a lesson?
 5. How does teaching with accuracy protect the church and honor God (Titus 1:9; Deuteronomy 4:2)?
-

VIII. Ministry / Application

1. **For teachers:** Build each lesson around one primary passage, then use supporting texts only after the main context is clear.
2. **For preachers:** Check every sermon point by reading the surrounding paragraph or chapter to ensure you are not forcing the text.

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3. For discipleship: Train believers to read whole chapters and to ask, “What did this mean to the original audience?” before asking, “How does this apply to me?”

4. For all workers: Keep a “context check” habit—before quoting any verse publicly, read at least 10 verses before and after, and confirm how it fits the chapter’s main argument.

IX. Memory Verse

1. 2 Timothy 2:15 — “Study to shew thyself approved unto God, a workman that needeth not to be ashamed, rightly dividing the word of truth.”

Chapter 16 — Teaching With Clarity and Authority

Structure • Clarity • Precision • Apostolic
Identity

Chapter 16 — Teaching With Clarity and Authority

Structure • Clarity • Precision • Apostolic Identity

I. Introduction: Apostolic Teaching Requires Clarity, Conviction, and Authority

Apostolic teaching is the proclamation of revealed truth with clarity, conviction, and spiritual authority.

II. Structure in Teaching

1. Order Reflects the Nature of God

Structure reflects the orderliness of God.

2. Teaching Must Be Decent and in Order

“Let all things be done decently and in order” (1 Corinthians 14:40).

3. Begin With Scripture

A lesson must begin with Scripture.

4. Explain the Text Clearly

Ezra read “distinctly and gave the sense” (Nehemiah 8:8).

5. Move From Explanation to Application

A lesson must move from explanation to application.

6. Teach for Obedience

“Whosoever heareth... and doeth them” (Matthew 7:24).

III. Clarity and Plainness

1. Avoid Persuasive Manipulation

Avoid persuasive manipulation.

2. Refuse Enticing Words

“Not with enticing words of man’s wisdom” (1 Corinthians 2:4).

3. Speak Truth Plainly

Speak truth plainly.

4. Use Plainness of Speech

“We use great plainness of speech” (2 Corinthians 3:12).

5. Refuse Self-Serving Motives

Avoid teaching for personal gain.

6. Do Not Teach for Filthy Lucre

“Not for filthy lucre” (1 Peter 5:2).

IV. Precision in Doctrine

1. Teach Doctrine Exactly as Scripture Presents It

Doctrine must be taught exactly as Scripture presents it.

2. Speak Sound Doctrine

“Speak thou the things which become sound doctrine” (Titus 2:1).

3. Guard Your Words Carefully

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Guard your words carefully.

4. Take Heed to Doctrine

“Take heed unto... the doctrine” (1 Timothy 4:16).

5. Avoid Vague or Ambiguous Teaching

Avoid vague or ambiguous teaching.

6. Speak the Same Thing

“Speak the same thing” (1 Corinthians 1:10).

V. Apostolic Identity in Teaching

1. Be Rooted in the Apostles’ Doctrine

Rooted in the apostles’ doctrine.

2. Continue Steadfastly

“They continued steadfastly in the apostles’ doctrine” (Acts 2:42).

3. Resist Cultural Pressure

Resist cultural pressure.

4. Refuse Conformity to the World

“Be not conformed to this world” (Romans 12:2).

5. Uphold Holiness

Uphold holiness.

6. Be Holy in All Manner of Conversation

“Be ye holy in all manner of conversation” (1 Peter 1:15).

7. Exalt the Name of Jesus

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Exalt the name of Jesus.

8. Teach the Fullness of God in Christ

“In him dwelleth all the fulness of the Godhead bodily” (Colossians 2:9).

Teaching with clarity and authority equips the worker to guard the flock faithfully.

VI. Summary

1. Apostolic teaching must be orderly and Scripture-first, moving from explanation to application so learners can obey what they hear.
 2. Teaching must avoid manipulation and rely on truth spoken plainly rather than pressure, performance, or personal gain.
 3. Doctrine should be communicated precisely, with careful language that preserves sound teaching and avoids ambiguity.
 4. Apostolic teachers maintain identity by continuing in the apostles’ doctrine, resisting cultural conformity, upholding holiness, and exalting the name of Jesus.
-

VII. Study Questions

1. Why does Scripture require teaching to be done “decently and in order” (1 Corinthians 14:40), and what does orderly teaching look like in practice?
2. What are common forms of manipulation in teaching, and how can a teacher remain both persuasive and truthful without pressuring people?
3. Why does doctrinal precision matter, and what kinds of “vague” teaching tend to create confusion in the church?

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4. How can a teacher “take heed unto... the doctrine” (1 Timothy 4:16) while also communicating simply to new believers?
 5. What habits help a church maintain apostolic identity in a culture that pressures conformity (Romans 12:2)?
-

VIII. Ministry / Application

1. For teachers: Prepare each lesson with a clear structure: (1) primary text, (2) explanation, (3) key doctrine statements, and (4) specific application.

2. For preachers: Remove pressure tactics and let Scripture carry the weight—invite response, but do not manipulate emotions.

3. For leaders: Establish shared doctrinal language (key phrases and definitions) so the team “speaks the same thing” (1 Corinthians 1:10).

4. For the church: Practice apostolic identity through doctrine, holiness, and worship centered on Jesus’ name and revelation.

IX. Memory Verse

1. 1 Corinthians 14:40 — “Let all things be done decently and in order.”

Chapter 17 — Guarding the Flock

Discernment • Correction • Unity •
Watchfulness

Chapter 17 — Guarding the Flock

Discernment • Correction • Unity • Watchfulness

I. Introduction: The Worker's Responsibility to Guard the Flock

The flock is precious to God, and the worker must guard it with vigilance and humility.

II. Identifying False Doctrine

1. Recognize the Threat of False Doctrine

False doctrine has always threatened the church. “Beware of false prophets” (Matthew 7:15).

2. Understand How Deception Imitates Truth

False doctrine imitates truth. “Satan... transformed into an angel of light” (2 Corinthians 11:14).

3. Test Teaching by Scripture

Test everything by Scripture. “Try the spirits” (1 John 4:1).

4. Watch for Persuasive Deception

False doctrine deceives the simple. “By good words and fair speeches deceive” (Romans 16:18).

III. Correcting with Humility

1. Accept Correction as a Biblical Responsibility

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Correction is a biblical responsibility. “Reprove, rebuke, exhort” (2 Timothy 4:2).

2. Correct with Gentleness

Correction must be gentle. “In meekness instructing those that oppose themselves” (2 Timothy 2:25).

3. Aim for Restoration

Correction aims for restoration. Jesus restored Peter (John 21:15–17).

4. Avoid Pride While Correcting

Correction must avoid pride. “Take heed lest he fall” (1 Corinthians 10:12).

IV. Protecting Unity Without Compromise

1. Root Unity in Truth

Unity is rooted in truth. “Perfectly joined together... in the same mind” (1 Corinthians 1:10).

2. Refuse Compromise That Destroys Witness

Compromise destroys witness. Paul confronted Peter (Galatians 2:11–14).

3. Let Truth Define Boundaries

Truth divides light from darkness. “I came not to send peace, but a sword” (Matthew 10:34).

4. Pursue Peace Without Surrendering Doctrine

Pursue peace without surrendering doctrine. “Follow peace... and holiness” (Hebrews 12:14).

V. The Watchman's Responsibility

1. Stay Awake as a Watchman

The watchman must stay awake. "I have made thee a watchman" (Ezekiel 3:17).

2. Warn Faithfully

The watchman must warn faithfully. "I ceased not to warn... with tears" (Acts 20:31).

3. Guard What Has Been Entrusted

Guard the doctrine entrusted to you. "Keep that which is committed to thy trust" (1 Timothy 6:20).

4. Protect the Flock From Wolves

Protect the flock from wolves. "The hireling fleeth... because he careth not for the sheep" (John 10:13).

A worker shaped by prayer, grounded in Scripture, clear in teaching, and vigilant in protection becomes a faithful steward of the flock of God.

VI. Summary

1. Workers must remain alert to false doctrine that imitates truth and deceives through persuasive speech, testing everything by Scripture.

2. Correction is a biblical duty that must be carried out with meekness, aiming at restoration rather than humiliation.

3. Unity is preserved by truth, not by compromise, and faithful leaders pursue peace without surrendering doctrine.

4. The watchman bears responsibility to warn, guard what is entrusted, and protect the flock from spiritual danger.

VII. Study Questions

1. What are common ways false doctrine imitates truth, and what safeguards help a church test teaching by Scripture (1 John 4:1)?
 2. Why can “good words and fair speeches” be spiritually dangerous, and how can workers discern deception (Romans 16:18)?
 3. What does correction “in meekness” look like in real situations, and how can a worker correct without pride (2 Timothy 2:25; 1 Corinthians 10:12)?
 4. How do you protect unity while refusing compromise, and what is the difference between peacekeeping and truth-keeping (1 Corinthians 1:10; Hebrews 12:14)?
 5. What does it mean to be a watchman, and what responsibilities come with guarding doctrine and protecting the flock (Ezekiel 3:17; 1 Timothy 6:20)?
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VIII. Ministry / Application

1. **For workers:** Create a simple doctrinal checkpoint for any teaching: primary text, context, and clear alignment with apostolic doctrine.
2. **For leaders:** Practice correction that is both clear and humble—address error quickly but speak as one accountable to God.
3. **For teams:** Protect unity by agreeing on core doctrine statements and refusing to “trade truth for peace.”

4. For the church: Pray for discernment and courage to resist deception while maintaining a spirit of restoration toward those who are misled.

IX. Memory Verse

1. 1 John 4:1 — “Beloved, believe not every spirit, but try the spirits whether they are of God: because many false prophets are gone out into the world.”

Closing Message

The Centrality of Jesus Christ

The revelation of Jesus Christ stands at the center of all Scripture. He is the anchor of the Apostolic church and the foundation for every doctrine presented in this manual. Truth is not determined by culture, sentiment, or tradition. Instead, it is shaped by the Word of God and revealed in the person of Jesus. The intent of this manual has been to declare that truth with clarity, conviction, and unwavering fidelity.

The Call to Live and Guard Doctrine

Doctrine is far more than information to be learned—it is revelation to be obeyed, lived, taught, and passed on. The Apostolic church is called to guard the faith that was once delivered to the saints. This includes walking in holiness, preaching the gospel with authority, discipling intentionally, and leading with integrity. These responsibilities are not limited to ministers; they belong to every believer who bears the name of Jesus.

Empowered for Ministry and Application

As you teach, preach, study, and apply the truths found in these pages, may the Spirit of God illuminate your understanding, strengthen your conviction, and deepen your devotion. Let this manual serve as a stable foundation for your life, ministry, and church—a resource that preserves truth amidst a changing world and equips the next generation to stand firm in the revelation of the One God in Jesus Christ.

One God in Jesus Christ

Exalting Jesus Above All

Above all, may everything you do exalt the name of Jesus—the fullness of the Godhead revealed, the Savior of the world, and the soon-coming King.

To Him be glory in the church, both now and forever.

In the name of Jesus Christ—the one true God revealed.